PLAY THEATER

Presents

Book by
Terrence McNally

Music and Lyrics by
Marc Shaiman & Scott Wittman

Vocal Music Arrangements by

John McDaniel & Marc Shaiman

Dance Music Arrangements by **Marc Shaiman**

Orchestrations by **Marc Shaiman & Larry Blank**

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MUSIC THEATRE INTERNATIONAL

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CHARACTERS

- Older Frank Junior
- Young Frank Junior
- Frank Abagnale Senior
- Paula Abagnale

- Agent Carl Hanratty
- Agent Branton
- Agent Dollar
- Agent Cod

- Brenda Strong
- Carol Strong
- Roger Strong

- Stewardesses & Nurses
  - Cindy
  - Mindy
  - Lindy
  - Jane
  - Kelly
  - Shellie
  - Nellie
  - Sherrie
  - Terri
  - Kerrie
- Cheryl Ann
- Airport Announcer
- Nerd
- Jock
- Principal Owings
- Betty
- Jack Barnes
- Judge
- Railroad Agent
- Swiss Army Knife Assistant
- India Ink Assistant
- Elmer’s Glue Assistant
- Pinstripe Girls
- Diane, Bank Teller
- Pan Am Executive
- Tailor
- Radio Announcer
- Hotel Manager
- Party Doctor
- Ben Casey
- Other Doctor
- Doctor Wannamaker
- Intern 1
- Intern 2
- Bartender
- Intercom Announcer
- Mitch Miller

ACT ONE

Prologue: Miami International Airport

(A central area of a large, ultra- modern airport—circa 1960s. Lights fade up.)

[SFX 1a] *We hear the sounds of JETS taking off and landing. ANNOUNCEMENTS murmur throughout. Courtesy phones, pages for passengers, calls for specific airlines and flights, mentioning long-gone airlines like TWA, Braniff, and Pan Am.*

AIRPORT ANNOUNCER
Welcome to Miami Dade International Airport. Braniff flight 663 service to New York's Idlewild Airport is now boarding.

(Cast members hurry back and forth, to and from their flights.)

(OLDER FRANK ABAGNALE, JR. has been sitting on an airport chair upstage left reading the newspaper. FBI Agents enter, revolvers drawn: BRANTON and DOLLAR. They mistakenly identify an airline passenger running for his flight.

BRANTON
There he is! Hold it right there!

DOLLAR
Stop or I'll shoot!

(AGENT CARL HANRATTY enters with the other agents.)

HANRATTY
Hold your fire! *(approaches passenger, lifts hat, realizes it's not him)* Where the heck is he? He's not giving us the slip this time.

(OLDER FRANK JR, carrying a suitcase, rises from the chair and quickly runs, still carrying his suitcase, with AGENT COD on his tail. The Agents chase him.)

Wait a minute, Men. There he goes! That's him! Goddangit that's him!

BRANTON
Don't move!

DOLLAR
I'll shoot! I will shoot!

(OLDER FRANK JR hesitates…)

COD
And he's a really bad shot.

... then takes off again. HANRATTY gives chase.

HANRATTY
Dammit!

COD *(overlapping)*
There. There he is!

BRANTON *(overlapping)*
No you don't!

DOLLAR *(overlapping)*
I'm gonna shoot!

[SFX 1b] *A deafening SHOT stops everyone in their tracks/ducks.*

HANRATTY
For the love of—Dollar, what does "hold your fire" mean where you come from?

DOLLAR *(proud)*
I fired a warning shot, Agent Hanratty!

COD *(squints at ceiling)*
I think you shot down a plane.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
That was close! You could hurt someone.

HANRATTY
Come on, Frank. I'd rather take you alive than dead.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Can I at least make a statement first?

HANRATTY
At the airport? No.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'm sure these people want to know why you're shooting at me. *(looks to cast: they kind of do)*
I think they should know who I am and what I did and why I did it.

HANRATTY
This is one of your tricks. Men!

(Jerks his head to the Agents, who close in)

You're not going to fool me again, Frank, like you did in that hotel room in L.A. You're not putting on a show for these people.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
A show?

[SFX: 1c Prologue*.] OLDER FRANK JUNIOR looks at us and smiles.)*

A show.

(OLDER FRANK JUNIOR snaps his fingers. MUSIC CONTINUES with a huge timpani roll.)

We need some lights.

(He waves his arm. Lights change.)

COD
The hell is he doing?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
A studio audience.

HANRATTY
Misdirection. It's a con.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Cameras.

HANRATTY
That's the technique.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
And the Frank Abagnale Junior Orchestra!

(He waves to the Orchestra.)

HANRATTY
Frank, what the hell are you doing? Branton, Cod, get everyone out of here.

(As the other agents hurry the passengers to the their next places, HANRATTY edges upstage to check out the orchestra, keeping his gun on Older Frank Junior who crosses downstage to us.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
My name is Frank William Abagnale ... Junior. This is my story.

HANRATTY
These people have musical instruments.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I was a millionaire twice over and half again before I was twenty-one. I stole every nickel of it. I flew almost five million miles as a Pan Am pilot, practiced medicine at a top Atlanta hospital, and worked as a prosecutor for the State of Louisiana, all under assumed names.

[***SFX: 1d Live in Living Color.]***

Mister Hanratty thinks he has all the facts, but only I know just how I did it. And I did it in style.

(He stands in center of largest LED lit frame.)

<u>SONG: LIVE IN LIVING COLOR</u>

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
LET ME TAKE YOU FOR A RIDE
YES, I'M LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
SO, SIT BACK AND LET ME BE YOUR T.V. GUIDE!

(The groove kicks in.)

HANRATTY
All right, that’s enough. Frank, you're coming in. Now.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Mister Hanratty, when that shot rang out, my whole life flashed before my eyes. I saw it all! Well I mean, the highlights. Like on a television special or something. Like we used to watch, mom and dad and me.

HANRATTY
You think your life is a T.V. special?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I know. Modesty has never been one of my virtues.

HANRATTY
Virtue has never been one of your virtues.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
True story.

I GOTTA STORY I'D LIKE TO TELL
BUT I'M GONNA NEED HELP TO TELL IT WELL
I GOTTA STORY ABOUT FAME AND MONEY
AND IT'S GOT MORE CURVES THAN A PLAYBOY BUNNY
I WANNA LIVE NOT JUST SURVIVE
I WANNA TELL MY STORY LIVE
AND IN LIVING COLOR!

(The cast has started participating like a ‘60’s variety show, and HANRATTY finds himself surrounded by dancing bodies ...)

ALL
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
SOMETHING SPECIAL'S UP TONIGHT
YES I'M

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR + ALL
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
LIFE AIN'T LIVED IN BLACK AND WHITE!

Ladies and gentlemen, the Frank Abagnale Junior Singers and Dancers!

(HANRATTY fights his way through the Frank Abagnale Junior Singers and Dancers and speaks to us.)

HANRATTY
Hold on, Folks, listen, by the time this guy was twenty years old, he had stolen almost

one-point-eight million dollars. He's a con man, plain and simple. Has been since the age of sixteen, when he bilked twenty grand from his father's Mobil card to buy presents for girls. When he got caught his only excuse was—

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I like girls.

HANRATTY
He likes girls. Tell the folks, Frank, how "I like girls" becomes "I'm wanted on five continents."

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Oh, you mean like the story of how Superman became Superman?

HANRATTY *(half beat)*
Your ability to pull myth from manure is truly impressive.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Thank you!

I GOT A TALE OF A GREAT ROMANCER
AND IT'S GOT MORE MOVES THAN A GO-GO DANCER
I GOT A STORY THAT'S FAST AND SLICK
AND IT'S GOT MORE TWISTS THAN A PEPPERMINT STICK
I DON'T HAVE FOR THE NINE TO FIVE I WANNA TELL MY STORY
LIVE AND IN LIVING

OLDER FRANK JR. + ALL
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
AND IT'S BROUGHT TO YOU BY ME
YES IT'S

ALL + OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
THIS WON'T FIT IN YOUR T.V.!

Also starring my parents, Frank and Paula Abagnale!

(MUSIC CHANGES. FRANK SENIOR, YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR and PAULA enter in a sweep, and begin to dance together, beautifully. They are mirrored by two other dancing couples. Stunning and romantic.)

My parents met in France. A little village called Montrichard. After the war. My dad was a GI. My mother was young and beautiful.

FRANK SENIOR *(to us)*
All the people in that little French village were so happy to see Americans that they decided to put on a show for us. So they crammed two hundred soldiers into a tiny social hall and the first person to walk on stage is your mother, and she starts to dance... The men are literally holding their breath. And I turned to my buddies and I said—

FRANK SENIOR + OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
—I am not leaving France without that woman.

PAULA
I always get into trouble when I dance with you. *(They dance. YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR watches.)*

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
When I was a kid, I could watch them dance all night.

(FRANK SENIOR sweeps PAULA off her feet, and they dance off. HANRATTY steps in.)

[SFX 1e Live in Living Color II]

HANRATTY
Frank, come on, I interviewed both your parents, don't try to sell me some sentimental picture of domestic bliss—

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Also starring Playboy's Playmate of the Year, Cheryl Ann ... Something!

CHERYL ANN
I'm surprised you even remembered my first name. Listen, you no good sonofa—

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Thank you, Cheryl Ann! And introducing the Strong family, featuring the beautiful, sweet, faithful and true Brenda Strong, R.N.!

(Lights on BRENDA, with ROGER and CAROL STRONG behind her)

BRENDA
Hi, Frank!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Hi, Brenda. Listen, I've got this show to do and you're gonna be in it. In fact, you’re one of the stars.

BRENDA
Frank, I wouldn’t do this for anyone but you.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
You're gonna be great. Now, will you wait for me over there? I'll let you know when it's time.

BRENDA
Frank. I love you.

(BRENDA exits with her parents, YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR watches. And says, to himself:)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I loved you, too.

(HANRATTY has had enough.)

HANRATTY
All right, Frank. I've heard all I can hear. I don't want to hear any more.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I don’t believe you. I think you want the rest of the story.

HANRATTY
I know the whole story – All right, wait a minute, there’s something that still bugs me. How’d you pass the bar exam? In New Orleans? How’d you cheat the bar?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
All right Mr. Hanratty I’ll make you a deal. You let me finish, and I’ll tell you anything. We owe each other that much, don’tcha think? I’ll get to tell my story. And you’ll have a full confession.

HANRATTY
Okay, deal. Frank. Or whatever you're calling yourself today … wait … where am I going?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR	ALL
WHAT'S IN A NAME?	
	SHOO-BEE DOO-WOP, BOP-BOP
JUST WINDOW DRESSING	
	SHOO-BEE DOO-WOP, BOP-BOP
EVERYBODY KNOWS THAT IT'S THE CLOTHES THAT MAKE THE MAN	
	CLOTHES THAT MAKE THE MAN
PLAY THE GAME	
	SHOO-BEE DOO-WOP, BOP-BOP
JUST KEEP 'EM GUESSING	
	SHOO-BEE DOO-WOP, BOP-BOP
MIX AND MATCH ME TRY TO CATCH ME IF YOU CAN	
OH, I GOTTA STORY THAT'S STRANGE BUT TRUE	
	I GOTTA STORY THAT'S STRANGE BUT TRUE
SO COME FLY WITH ME FOR A BIRD'S-EYE VIEW	
	SO COME FLY WITH ME FOR A BIRD'S-EYE VIEW
I'VE GOT THE WORLD AT MY COMMAND	
	I'VE GOT THE WORLD AT MY COMMAND
AND I'LL BE YOUR ONE-MAN DISNEYLAND	
	AND I'LL BE YOUR ONE-MAN DISNEYLAND
I DON’T WANNA WAIT FOR THE COPS TO ARRIVE	
I WANNA TELL MY STORY LIVE AND IN LIVING COLOR	LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
TUNE ME IN AND TURN ME ON, YES I'M LIVE IN LIVING COLOR	LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
BLINK YOUR EYES AND I'LL BE GONE, YES I'M LIVE IN LIVING COLOR	LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
TUNE ME IN AND TURN ME ON, YES I'M	LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

BLINK YOUR EYES
BLINK YOUR EYES
AND I'LL BE GONE

BLINK YOUR EYES
BE GONE!

Scene 1: Living Room, The Abagnale House, New Rochelle

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Ladies and gentlemen, our story begins on Christmas Eve, 1964, New Rochelle, New York. The Abagnale home. A beautiful house on the best street. The house everyone wanted, and the family everyone wanted to be.

(PAULA trims the Christmas Tree. FRANK SENIOR watches her. YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR is watching a small color television set.)

PAULA
It truly is a beautiful tree, Frank.

FRANK SENIOR
It's the genuine spirit of real Christmas, right there - one hundred percent acrylic.

PAULA
But – so that I understand – you left this morning with a Cadillac and two hundred dollars and come home with a Christmas tree, a television set, and a used Ford?

FRANK SENIOR
Can I strike a bargain or what? I left those guys with their heads spinning.

PAULA
I think I know the feeling.

FRANK SENIOR
It's that Abagnale magic. C'mon – dance with me.

PAULA
Frank, I DO have dinner going-

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR *(looking at TV)*
Wow Dad, you're right—everything is better in color.

FRANK SENIOR
How about that thirteen-inch screen?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
It's like Andy Williams is right here in our living room.

FRANK SENIOR
Nothing's too good for my boy or my bride.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
But Dad, didn't those guys know you were getting away with something?

FRANK SENIOR
People only know what you tell them, Frankie. It’s all a dance – swap the Caddy for the Ford, use the extra cash to pay the mortgage, use the mortgage to leverage the bank loan, use the loan to tide the business over until you can get the Caddy back. There’s always another move to make.

PAULA *(pulls away, exits.)*
I really should see to dinner.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
That’s great you got the loan, Dad.

FRANK SENIOR
Shh. I didn’t get the loan.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
You didn’t – but I thought you said-

FRANK SENIOR
I got something better. *(Hands him a checkbook.)* Fifty checks. The account's in your name. I put twenty-five dollars in it so you can buy whatever you want. Don't tell your mother.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Thanks, Dad. But if they didn't give you the loan, why did you —

FRANK SENIOR
One day you’re gonna want something from these people. A house, a car. They have all the money. And this means from this day on, you're in their little club.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
But why didn't they give you the loan?

FRANK SENIOR
Ah, it’s just a technicality. They won't loan to anyone under I.R.S. investigation.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Oh.

FRANK SENIOR
Listen to me. You remember this story. Two little mice fell into a bucket of cream. The first mouse quickly gave up and drowned. The second mouse wouldn't quit. He struggled so hard that eventually he churned that cream into butter …

FRANK SENIOR AND YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
… and he climbed out.

FRANK SENIOR
And who are we?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
We're the second mouse.

FRANK SENIOR
Damn straight we are. We're gonna be fine. As a matter of fact, you know what ? We're going downtown to buy you your Christmas present. A brand new Botany 500 suit.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Dad, that's too expensive.

FRANK SENIOR
Frankie. You know why the Yankees win all the time? It's not the Mick. It's not Joe Pepitone. It's the uniform. The other teams just stand there, staring at the pinstripes, mesmerized.

SFX 2b)The Pinstripes are All That They See II

The Dodgers were so scared they had to leave town.

<u>THE PINSTRIPES ARE ALL THAT THEY SEE</u>

FRANK SENIOR
WHEN YOUR MOTHER WALKED IN
TO THAT DANCEHALL IN MONTRICHARD
WHAT DID SHE SEE?
THROUGH THE HAZE OF CHAMPAGNE
DID SHE NOTICE MY BRAIN
OR MY COLLEGE DEGREE?

KID, WHAT SHE SAW WAS THE UNIFORM!
THROUGH THE DIRT AND DEBRIS
YEAH, THOSE LADIES GAVE THANKS TO US VISITING YANKS
CAUSE THE PINSTRIPES ARE ALL THAT THEY SEE

(FRANK SENIOR is joined by a bevy of BEAUTIFUL GIRLS fitting YOUNG FRANK JUINOR for a suit. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR comes downstage: our host.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Ladies and gentlemen, the smartest man I know. The man with all the moves, my dad—Frank ... Abagnale ... Senior!

<u>FRANK SENIOR</u>
WHEN A PILOT WALKS ONTO THE PLANE
ALL THE PASSENGERS SMILE AND RELAX

DO THEY SEE HE'S STILL TIGHT FROM
THAT PARTY LAST NIGHT
AND THE BACK TO BACK "JACKS"?

<u>BEAUTIFUL GIRLS</u>
OOOOOOOH

SMILE AND RELAX
SMILE AND RELAX

STEWED TO THE MAX

FRANK SENIOR
NO!, WHAT THEY SEE IS THE UNIFORM
HOW IT FITS TO A TEE
LIKE THAT VISITING TEAM
THAT THE YANKEES WILL CREAM
THE PINSTRIPES ARE ALL THAT THEY SEE

IF YOU WANNA BE A SOMEONE
YOU CAN'T LOOK LIKE A BUM
A BOOK'S JUDGED BY IT'S COVER

THAT'S THE FIRST RULE OF THUMB

I WANNA SEE YA TAKE OFF
STRAIGHT TO THE TOP FLOOR
START DRESSIN' TO IMPRESS 'EM
SON YOU'LL STROLL IN THE FRONT DOOR
A KID IN A MAN'S CANDY STORE …

(As OLDER FRANK JUNIOR speaks to us, JACK BARNES and PAULA enter, not quite separately. JACK goes to FRANK SENIOR and shakes his hand. PAULA comes to YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR. Music continues as we continue to:)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Everybody loved my dad. Jack Barnes, the head of the Chamber of Commerce, called him—

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR + JACK BARNES
—the most popular businessman in New Rochelle!

PAULA
Frankie, you don't have to wear your school blazer. You're going to public school now.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I'm used to it. And, I mean, what's the Flash without his suit? Anyway, public school is only for now. Dad'll get back on his feet and I'll be back at St. Francis before you know it.

PAULA
My brave little soldier. You aren't afraid of anything.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I'll be fine, Mom. You do what you have to do.

PAULA
Well, you do look handsome. Comme tu es beau!
(She sighs, kisses him on the cheek, and goes.)

Scene 2: New Rochelle High School *(transition mid-song)*

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR heads to school. He is met by a JOCK and a NERD)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
'Scuse me, is this room 17 French?

NERD *(checking his outfit)*
Who wants to know? The F.B.I.?

(The two students laugh and move past him, the Jock accidentally-on-purpose bumping YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR and sending him stumbling.)

JOCK
Yeah. He looks like a ... like a substitute teacher or somethin'.

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR looks at us and smiles.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR

Shouldn't you boys be in class? Depechez-vous. Vite. Vite. Vite.

(Lights change for Principal's Office. FRANK SENIOR and PAULA are with a dour female PRINCIPAL.)

PRINCIPAL OWINGS
Mr. and Mrs. Abagnale, I regret to inform you that for the past week, Frank has been teaching Mrs. Glaser's French class.

PAULA
He what?

PRINCIPAL OWINGS
Your son has been pretending to be a substitute teacher. Lecturing the students, giving out homework. Your son held three teacher-parent conferences yesterday, and was planning a class field trip to a French Fry Factory in Trenton.

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR waits, nervously, outside the Principal's office.)

PAULA
You have to forgive him. There's been so much change. We lost our house—

FRANK SENIOR *(smoothly cuts her off)*
Principal Owings, on my way in from the outer office, I found this necklace on the floor. Is it yours? *(He pulls a locket necklace from his pocket.)*

PAULA
Frank, please.

FRANK SENIOR
You must have dropped it. Looks like it was made for you.

PRINCIPAL OWINGS
Well. Mister Abagnale.

(But she takes it. As FRANK SENIOR shakes hands with the PRINCIPAL, who exits opposite, PAULA goes to YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR.)

PAULA
Frankie … Je ne peux pas.

(She shakes her head again and goes. Frank Senior takes her place, putting on his hat.)

FRANK SENIOR
French fry factory?!

[SFX 2b)The Pinstripes are All That They See II]

(Looks at his son, who slowly meets his gaze.) (Finally, FRANK SENIOR laughs. And YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR laughs.)

FRANK SENIOR + YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
YEAH, WE'RE GONNA HIT THE HIGH-LIFE
WE'VE ONLY JUST BEGUN

WE'RE GONNA BE TOGETHER FRANK SENIOR AND SON

DINE AT "THE LATIN QUARTER"
A NIGHTCAP AT "TOOTS SHOR"
YEAH, WE'RE GONNA BE AT RINGSIDE
LIFE WILL BE BETTER THAN BEFORE
FOR TWO KIDS IN A MAN'S CANDY STORE

(FRANK SENIOR claps his son on the shoulder and goes.YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR goes back into school and sees BETTY.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Hi.

BETTY
Hi. Is the Principal in her office? I need to give her this note from my mother, excusing me from sixth period.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
You should fold it. It's more believable that way.

BETTY
No, this really is a note from my mother.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
What's the first thing you do when your mother hands you a note? You fold it up and put it in your pocket.

(A half-beat, and Betty folds the note.)

BETTY
Thanks. I'm Betty.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Frank.

BETTY
Nice jacket.

(He swoons and sings.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
WHAT THEY SEE IS THE UNIFORM
JUST ASK ONE MAITRE D'
OR A TAILOR IN PARIS
GO ASK ROGER MARIS!
THE PINSTRIPES ARE ALL THAT THEY SEE

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR dances his way home as we transition to ...)

Scene 3: The Abagnale Apartment, Downtown New Rochelle

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Mom, Dad I met this girl –

(... and as YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR dances right on in the door, his mother and father dance on opposite. But with a turn, in an instant, we see that it's not his father. It's JACK BARNES. And YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR sees this, and they see him. Music stops suddenly.)

PAULA
Frankie! You remember your father's friend, Jack Barnes?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Hello.

JACK BARNES
Frank. Good to see you. Paula … I … Take care. *(He grabs his hat and goes. YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR is silent.)*

PAULA
Are you hungry, Frankie? I'll make you a sandwich. *(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR doesn't move.)* Frankie? *(No answer.)* You're not going to tell him.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
No.

PAULA
That's right. There's nothing to tell. I'm going out for a few hours to visit some old friends from the tennis club, and when I get back, we'll all have dinner together, right? *(PAULA gets her pocketbook.)* Do you need some money, Frankie? A few dollars to buy some comic books? Here, take two.

(She stuffs two dollar bills in his pants pocket. He doesn't acknowledge her. Then …)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Two hundred soldiers in that tiny social hall, and you ... you ...

PAULA
I was sixteen years old when I met your father. I was your age. How could I know what I wanted? *Dites donc*?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
You wanted him.

PAULA
I did, once. And I wanted to get out of France. And I wanted to have a child. *(She reaches for him, but he pulls away. Considers him, then,)* It was a long time ago, Frankie. Believe me, one day you'll look at yourself, and you won't be who you were.

(He turns away from her. She exits. He takes a Flash comic from his pocket.)

SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR

THERE'S NO PHONE BOOTH
THERE'S NO CAPE
THERE'S NO STEVE MCQUEEN
TO HELP ME MAKE MY GREAT ESCAPE

HOW CAN I FLY
LIKE A HERO IN THE SKY
BE A SHOOTING STAR OUT IN THE STRATOSPHERE

WHERE'S "THE SHADOW"?
HE MIGHT KNOW
WHERE'S THAT SEARCHLIGHT
IN THE SKY TO POINT THE WAY TO GO?
THROUGH SOME NEW CLOUD
TO DISAPPEAR INTO THE CROWD
THOUGH THE FUTURE'S DARK
THERE'S ONE THING CRYSTAL CLEAR
THAT THERE'S NO HOME HERE …

(music continues as we transition to:)

Scene 4: Family Court and Train Station, New Rochelle

(The FAMILY COURT JUDGE appears with FRANK SENIOR and PAULA ...)

JUDGE
Son, listen to me. We just need a name. Your mother or your father.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
One day the principal pulls me out of class and drives me to the Courthouse. Doesn't tell me why. I walk in and I see my parents up front, with their lawyers, and the judge.

JUDGE
It can get very expensive, people fighting over their children.

PAULA
Nobody's fighting. Frankie, Look at me. Nobody's fighting.

(The adults continue, overlapping, as YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR sings to us.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
SO MANY VOICES TELLING ME TO CHOOSE

JUDGE
The court can decide these things, but it's better if the family does.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
IT'S LIKE A GAME WHERE EITHER TEAM I LOSE

FRANK SENIOR
Frankie, just give them a name, and this will all be over. It's going to be okay.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
THIS KINDA NOISE JUST MAKES ME WANNA SHOUT

PAULA
My brave little soldier. Do what you have to do.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I'D LIKE TO BUY A ONE-WAY TICKET OUT

FRANK SENIOR
I’m sorry, Frankie. I’ve got no room to move here.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
RULES OF THE ROAD SAY DON’T LOOK BACK
EYES STRAIGHT AHEAD, DON’T JUMP THE TRACK
TRY A NEW GAME, AND PRAY THAT I CAN WIN
'CAUSE I JUST DON'T FEEL AT HOME IN MINE
SO I'LL SLIP NOW INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

(And as the music hits a driving groove, YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR turns and runs. The Family Court disappears. He is on the street, COMMUTERS hurrying to and fro.)

ALL
HOO-HOO
HOO HOO

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR	ALL
I SEE THE MAPS FROM	
EVERY BOOK I’VE READ	
THE WORLDS THAT I HAVE LIVED	
INSIDE MY HEAD	
I THOUGHT A LOVE LIKE THEIRS	
WOULD NEVER DIE	
IF IT CAN FADE AWAY THEN SO CAN I	
FIRST YOU SEE ME THEN YOU DON’T	
	OOOOOOO
DON’T LOOK FOR ME YOU	
KNOW I WON’T	KNOW I WON’T
EVEN BE THERE	
SO LET THE GAMES BEGIN	
‘CAUSE I JUST DON'T FEEL AT HOME	
IN MINE SO I'LL SLIP NOW	AH AH AH AH
INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN.	HOO-HOO
SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN.	HOO-HOO

(The RAILROAD AGENT appears and YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR approaches. He holds out a couple of crumpled bills)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
One for Grand Central Station, please.

RAILROAD AGENT
Round trip is five dollars. One way is three. You have two.

(The Railroad Agent holds up the bills. MUSIC CHANGES.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Okay, so I didn't really know what I was doing, I just knew I had to get out, and I'm not proud of this

but my instincts took over. Misdirection. Maintain eye contact. Keep talking. And I take my money back from the ticket seller and I make it disappear —

(He does, using a nifty bit of sleight-of-hand. MUSIC CHANGES.)

— and I spin some tale about meeting my grandmother at Idlewild while I ask for my change, even though he doesn't owe me any change —

RAILROAD AGENT
Wait, what?

OLDER JUNIOR
— but I keep talking, and waiting for my change, or in this case my money back, and in his confusion he thinks he owes me change, and he gives me two dollars, so now I have four dollars which is enough for my one-way ticket to Manhattan, because I don't plan on coming back—

(The RAILROAD AGENT takes the money from YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR, who turns to go)

RAILROAD AGENT
Hold it!

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
What?

RAILROAD AGENT
Your ticket.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Thanks.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Like I said, I'm not proud of it, but you do what you have to do. I had to find a way out, and this is the way I found. They wanted me to choose ... and I chose. The New Haven line. Track Two, the ten-fifteen to New York City!

[SFX 3b)Someone Else's Skin]

YOUNG FRANK JR	ALL
RUN DOWN THE STREET	RUN DOWN THE STREET
RUN OUT OF TOWN	RUN OUT OF TOWN
I'M GONNA RUN	
FROM THE HOME TEAM	
AND NEVER TOUCH DOWN	
RUN FROM THE BOOKS	RUN FROM THE BOOKS
'CAUSE IT'S ALL BEEN A FAKE	'CAUSE IT'S ALL BEEN A FAKE
I'M GONNA RUN	
FROM THE CHOICES	
THAT I DON'T WANNA MAKE	
SCHOOL'S NOT OUT BUT I CAN'T WAIT	AHHHHHHHHHH
IT'S THE PERFECT TIME TO GRADUATE	AHHHHHHHHHH
TODAY	TODAY
I'VE GOTTA RUN AWAY NOW	

I'VE GOT TO RUN AWAY	
	OLDER FRANK JR
I KNOW THEY'LL SEE THE TRUTH WHEN I MOVE ON THEY'LL NEED EACH OTHER MUCH MORE ONCE I'M GONE	I KNOW THEY'LL SEE THE TRUTH WHEN I MOVE ON THEY'LL NEED EACH OTHER MUCH MORE ONCE I'M GONE
AND WHEN I'M FLUSH AND HE'S BACK ON HIS FEET I'LL PICK HIM UP AND RIDE DOWN EASY STREET	AND WHEN I'M FLUSH AND HE'S BACK ON HIS FEET I'LL PICK HIM UP AND RIDE DOWN EASY STREET
	ALL
NO TIME TO CRY FOR ALL THE YEARS A RUSTY GAS TANK FULL OF TEARS GETS YOU NOWHERE NOT THE PLACES I WANT IN	OOOOOO FULL OF TEARS
AND I JUST DON'T FEEL AT HOME IN MINE SO I'LL SLIP NOW INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN. INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN. INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN. INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN. INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN.	AHHHHHHH AH AH AH AH INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN. INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN. INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN. INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN. INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN.

Scene 4b: On television. On stage.

(On applause OLDER FRANK JUNIOR comes downstage to speak to us.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
And now, ladies and gentlemen, a word from our sponsors! These great products can help you survive your first few weeks in New York with just fifty checks and a driver's license.

(Three ATTRACTIVE ASSISTANTS bring in the products as he describes them.)

Swiss Army Penknives can help you alter the age on your driver's license. Because a sixteen-year-old cashing a check or opening an account by himself—

SWISS ARMY KNIFE ASSISTANT(with army knife)
—gets a lot of questions!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Higgins brand Genuine Original India Ink flows easily through your pen or brush—a few dabs on your license, you're ten years older.

INDIA INK ASSISTANT (with bottle of ink)
And no one can tell the difference!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Elmer's Glue is perfect for the craftsperson of any age who needs to change their name. With a pair of scissors you can cut and paste names from other documents, and you're officially Frank Taylor

Junior. And if Frank Taylor wears out his welcome—

ELMER'S GLUE ASSISTANT (with Elmer's Glue)
You can be Frank Adams!

SWISS ARMY KNIFE ASSISTANT
Or Frank Conners.

INDIA INK ASSISTANT
Or William Taylor.

SWISS ARMY KNIFE ASSISTANT	INDIA INK ASSISTANT	ELMER'S GLUE ASSISTANT
A snip,		
	A dab,	
		A touch of glue

THREE ASSISTANTS
And you'll be good to go

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Big thanks to all our sponsors!

THREE ASSISTANTS
Now, right back to the show!

(Assistants exit, HANRATTY enters.)

HANRATTY
I know, I know. Very entertaining. Very good.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Ladies and Gentlemen! It's our very special guest star, Mister Hanratty.

HANRATTY
What he's leaving out folks, in his charming fashion, is the fact that in just a few short months this guy had soaked just about every branch of Chase Manhattan in the five boroughs and in northern New Jersey. He opened accounts all over the tri-state area, and dropped rubber in just about every hotel, grocery store, and dry cleaners from here to Hoboken. He was the Johnny Appleseed of fraud.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Mister Hanratty, thanks for stopping by, we're going to be seeing a lotta him in just a bit but right now there's a much more exciting turn of events.

(He escorts HANRATTY toward the wings but HANRATTY stays and keeps speaking to us.)

HANRATTY
He didn't know his bad checks were on my desk. He didn't know his mother had filed a missing-persons report. He didn't know that his clock was ticking.

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR is before DIANE, the Bank Teller at a counter.)

Scene 5: Chase Bank, Manhattan

DIANE THE BANK TELLER
I'm sorry, Mister Taylor. We can't cash this.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Say, Diane, I found this on the sidewalk out front, and I think it might be yours—

HANRATTY
It's not.

DIANE THE BANK TELLER
I'm sorry, Mister Taylor, we have new restrictions on cashing checks.

HANRATTY
Seems someone put out an F.B.I. bulletin.

DIANE THE BANK TELLER
If you'd like to leave us your home phone number, we can hold on to this—

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR drops the necklace in his valise, slides the check off the counter, backs away.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
You know, thank you, but I'm late. For an appointment. With my stockbroker. *(He backs away.)*

HANRATTY
He's going to try six more banks—same story. We were onto him.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Then why didn't he catch me?

HANRATTY
Only a matter of time.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Mister Hanratty's jumping ahead. He and I don't even meet face to face for months yet. Right now, he's still stuck at his desk. Trying to put it all together. See, when my first fifty checks ran out, I bought a little printing press and I made my own. While I was producing more rubber than a tire factory, Mister Hanratty and his team were trying to find my trail.

[SFX 4a) Live in Living Color (Reprise)]

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR (Reprise)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
AND THOUGH I'M LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
AT THE FBI THE SHOW'S IN BLACK AND WHITE.

(One of the ASSISTANTS returns with a tub of checks and hands it to OLDER FRANK JUNIOR. He dumps them all onto HANRATTY's table at the FBI office.)

Scene 6: F.B.I. Office

(FBI office comes into view. Agents BRANTON, COD, and DOLLAR are drowning in checks)

COD
Dollar! What have you done!

BRANTON
Yeah, Dollar, the next time we tell you to move file boxes, and you stack them ten high, could you make sure you're under them when they fall?

DOLLAR
Whoops!

HANRATTY
Leave the kid alone.

BRANTON
Come on, Hanratty. We always give the rookies a hard time. Don't you remember how they razzed you?

HANRATTY
Yes, and it's an experience I see no reason to repeat. Now listen, we have three or four major-league paper hangers somewhere in this mess, so we are going to sort it out, even if it means we drop dead at our desks and our fossilized bones are discovered in some archeological dig in the twenty-first century.

[SFX: 4b)FBI Office underscore

COD
C'mon Hanratty it's 4:45. It's Thanksgiving.

HANRATTY
Listen — We do the job because it's the job and as long as I'm Interim Second Assistant Special Agent in Charge of the Bank Fraud and Forgery Subdivision, North Atlantic region — thank you very much — we will do the job until it's done. Thanksgiving or no Thanksgiving.

BRANTON
That's easy for you to say, Hanratty. Some of us still have wives.

HANRATTY
Low blow, Agent Branton. And, by the way, go home for lunch one of these days, unannounced, and see how that works out for you. *(The men laugh.)*

DOLLAR
He got you there.

BRANTON
Shouldn't you be in another department? Like maybe daycare?

DOLLAR
I was auditing background checks for the Library of Congress and I asked for a transfer. I requested something where I could use my gun. I like guns. And cars. Anything loud or fast, basically.

HANRATTY
How about Shelley Winters? She's loud and fast. Come on, Dollar, I know that this job is not as exciting as fieldwork, or counter-intelligence—

COD
Or a long, slow death.

HANRATTY *(speaking distractedly while looking closely at 2-3 checks)*
—and maybe nobody knows you're down here. But he does. Oh yeah, he does. The one you're after. He knows. And the day you catch him, and you will, the day you slap those cuffs on him and watch them haul him away—oh, now this is interesting. This is very, very interesting.

BRANTON
I know you think so, and that's the sad thing.

HANRATTY
Look at these two. He's changing the MICR numbers on the checks.

DOLLAR
Micker? Micker Mouse?

COD
Who the hell is Micker Mouse?

HANRATTY
MICR! MICR! M-I-C-R. Magnetic Ink Character Recognition. Jiminy Christmas, Frank Taylor must've got his hands on a MICR encoder. *(looks at the other check)* And Frank Williams too. Look here. If you change a zero-two to a one-two, a check that was cashed in New York gets rerouted all the way to San Francisco and it's weeks before the bank that cashed it knows they're bad.

DOLLAR
You mean those numbers at the bottom the check actually mean something?

HANRATTY
They mean that Frank Taylor and Frank Williams and William Franklin are the same person. They mean that he can stay in one place and write bad checks for weeks and weeks. And that means there must be thousands more checks just like this out there – more bum checks than a Prague prison!

BRANTON, COD + DOLLAR
Nooooo!

HANRATTY
And that means no Christmas for you MICR mouse. *(He points at Cod.)* And no Hanukah either.

> *(MUSIC. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR returns and the men sweep the checks onto the lifts as we TRANSITION TO:)*

Scene 7: Outside the Tudor Hotel, Manhattan, and in the Skies

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Well, that should keep Mister Hanratty busy for a while. But unfortunately he was right. My clock was ticking. I'd always wanted to be good at something. Now I was really good ... at passing bad checks. I was a crook, nothing more, and the shelf life was getting shorter. But then one day, I went walking past the Tudor Hotel on 42nd Street, and destiny came walking out those revolving doors.

[SFX 4c) Jet Set intro]

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR almost collides with a beautiful young Pan Am STEWARDESS emerging, travel bags in hand.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Oh!! Excuse me.

STEWARDESS #1 (CINDY)
That's quite all right.

(She continues past him, as Frank watches, agape. A SECOND STEWARDESS comes through the door.)

STEWARDESS #2 (MINDY)
Excuse me.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Kinda late to be checking out, isn't it?

STEWARDESS #2 (MINDY)
We all have evening flights.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
"We all. ..?"

(A parade of STEWARDESSES, all in the same Pan Am outfit, march in through the door, satchels in hand. He bobs and weaves as they move through.)

Oh, I—excuse me—whoops!—hello, there ...*(to us)* Are you seeing this?

(STEWARDESS #3 bumps him on her way by...)

STEWARDESS #3 (LINDY)
Oh! Excuse me.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
No ... excuse me. Um. Who are you all waiting for?

THE STEWARDESSES
The pilots.

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR blinks. He smiles at us, then at her.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Excuse me, miss ... I've been training as a pilot. Is Pan Am hiring?

STEWARDESS #1 (CINDY)
Aren't you sweet. Here. Here it is. Talk to Jerry Taylor, VP of personnel. Tell him Cindy sent you.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Thank you, Miss Cindy. Tell me—is flying everything it's cracked up to be?

STEWARDESS #1 (CINDY)
The only thing better than flying—is what happens on the ground.

[SFX: 5) The Jet Set]

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(to us, our host:)*
Ladies and gentlemen, Cindy, Mindy, Lindy, Kelly, Shellie, Nellie, Sherrie, Terri, Kerrie, and Jane. I like to call them ... "The Jet Set."

<u>THE JET SET</u>

CINDY
WOKE UP IN BROOKLYN
WITH A FROWN UPON MY FACE

MINDY
JUST LEFT WISCONSIN
WHERE THERE'S CHEESE ENOUGH
TO START THIS RAT RACE

CINDY
BUT THANKS TO THE BROTHERS WRIGHT

CINDY + MINDY
WE DON'T KNOW WHERE WE'LL SLEEP TONIGHT

CINDY
YEAH, I'M A BIRD IN THE SKIES

MINDY
AND TOMORROW WHEN I RISE

LINDY
I'LL WAKE UP IN PARIS
WITH A NEW LOVE IN MY HEART

JANE
OR MAYBE GERMANY
WITH THAT BRAND NEW PET I MET IN STUTTGART

KELLY
SKIES THE LIMIT, TIME TO PLAY
I'LL PUT DOWN ROOTS SOME OTHER DAY

SHELLIE
NO NEED TO BE A LONELY JOE

STEWARDESSES
THE JET-SET IS THE
ONLY WAY TO GO

(One STEWARDESS puts a pair of horn-rimmed glasses on YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR. Another STEWARDESS gives him a camera and a notebook. A PAN AM EXECUTIVE enters.)

PAN AM EXECUTIVE
So you're the kid writing the article for the school paper?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR *(turns to him, now a high school kid)*
Yes sir. Frank Black from Monroe High School. I want to know everything there is to know about being a Pan Am pilot. For instance, what does it mean when one pilot says to another pilot, "I've been on the same equipment all week, jumpin' puddles for the weak and weary?"

PAN AM EXECUTIVE
Means they've been flying the same plane, short flights, mostly commuters.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
And what about those I.D. badges that I've seen pilots wear?

PAN AM EXEC
Every pilot has to have it with him at all times. It's an airline personnel badge, like this one here from Pan Am.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Thank you for your time, sir! Can I get a picture?

PAN EXECUTIVE
Oh, sure.

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR points the camera right at his ID badge. FLASH.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Got it!

(The EXECUTIVE goes and the STEWARDESSES are back.)

STEWARDESSES
WOULD'JA LIKE NEW MUSIC AND MYSTERY
EACH AND EVERYDAY
LOSE THE SAME OLD MUSIC AND HIST'RY
MAKE A NEW FRIEND THEN
FLY AWAY

(One Stewardess brings YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR an in-flight cart with familiar sponsor products: Penknife, scissors, glue, India ink. Frank holds up a blank piece of paper, and goes to work making a Pan Am Badge.)

AND … WAKE UP IN TEXAS
WHERE THEY TREAT THEIR WOMEN RIGHT
AND THEN TRY HOLLYWOOD
WHERE THE STARS GET LIT OUT IN BROAD DAYLIGHT

ANY CITY, NEAR OR FAR
FEELS TWICE AS GOOD AS WHERE YOU ARE
WHEN YOU'RE SICK OF THE STATUS QUO
THE JET-SET IS THE ONLY WAY TO GO …

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR holds up his completed badge.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
My Pan Am pilot's badge! How cool is that?

(A TAILOR enters, measuring tape and note pad in hand.)

TAILOR
Awfully young to be a pilot, aren't ya?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I get that a lot. I'm just a co-pilot.

TAILOR
Why so nervous?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
How would you feel if you lost your uniform your first week on the job?

TAILOR
Ah, I hear you. That'll be one forty-three ninety-seven.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Can I write you a check?

TAILOR
No—no checks, no cash. Just need your employee number.

(He pulls out a form and begins to fill it out. YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR tries to read it upside down, to count spaces for numbers:)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Sure. It's. Six. One. Four ... Three.(?) Four (?) Five.(?) S—

(But before he gets the next number out, the TAILOR nods, finished, and YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR pulls it back.)

TAILOR
Great! I'll bill Pan Am, they'll take it out of your next paycheck.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
That’s why Pan Am will always be around.

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR and the TAILOR go as the CAST enters with STEWARDESSES.)

ALL STEWARDESSES
WOULD’JA LIKE A SLEIGH RIDE, A HAYRIDE?
THEN KIDDO, JUST STAY HOME
BUT, IF YOU WANT JET-SET THEN GET SET
TO LEAVE BEHIND KANSAS
THERE’S NO PLACE LIKE ROME

WAKE UP IN RIO
HAVE YOUR COFFEE IN BRAZIL
EVERYONE WHEN REAL LIFE GETS YOU DOWN

TAKE A FAR-OUT, ONE-WAY
TRIP TO SPLITZVILLE

SWEDISH, GREEK OR JAPANESE
A STEWARDESS IS TRAINED TO PLEASE
SO IF YOU'VE GOT WHAT IT TAKES BELOW
WELL THEN FLY THIS BIRD LIKE CUPID'S BOW
CAUSE THE JET SET'S JUST A HOLIDAY
YEAH THE JET SET GOES
UP, UP AND AWAY ... SO FLY!

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR joins them, his uniform at last perfect, cap and aviators on. A stunning sight.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
RIGHT DOWN TO IT'LY FOR LA BELLA FEMINA
JUMP IN A FOUNTAIN

STEWARDESSES
WOO!
FOR A BIG DOSE OF LA DOLCE VITA

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
IF YOUR TASTES RUN MORE RISQUÉ

SHERRIE + TERRI + NELLIE
WELL THEN, WE KNOW A JOINT IN OLD BOMBAY

STEWARDESSES
SO HANG ON TIGHT LET'S LOOP DE LOOP
IT'S TIME TO FLY THIS CHICKEN COOP

ALL
SO PACK UP YOUR SUITCASE
CHECK YOUR WORRIES AT THE GATE
COME OUT AND PLAY BOY
CRUISE THE WORLD TO FIND
YOUR PERFECT PLAYMATE

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
THINGS LOOK BETTER FROM ABOVE
SO BUCKLE UP, NEXT STOP IS LOVE

ALL
FROM TIMBUKTU TO TOKYO
FROM MOZAMBIQUE TO MEXICO
THE JET SET IS THE
ONLY WAY TO GO

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
BABBADA BOP BOOP BAH BADOOBA DOO-OH!

(MUSIC begins again. As the others exit, YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR sees CHERYL ANN at

the St. Regis Hotel.)

Scene 8: The St. Regis Hotel, Manhattan

CHERYL ANN
Nice uniform.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Don't I know you from somewhere?

CHERYL ANN
Maybe. I was on the cover of Seventeen ... a few years ago.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Sure — you're that model! Cheryl Ann—something—in the Plaza. Could I get your autograph?

CHERYL ANN
Do you have a pen in your room? I think I do. So. Captain.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Call me Frank.

CHERYL ANN
Frank. Are you going to make me an offer?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I'm sorry — an offer for what?

CHERYL ANN
A man like you can buy me anything he wants. How much would you spend on a gift for me?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I — gosh, I really don't know, Cheryl. Um. Three hundred? Five hundred? A thousand dollars? One thousand dollars. I have to cash a check.

CHERYL ANN
You think this hotel is going to cash a thousand dollar check at three a.m.?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR *(pulls one out)*
They've done it for me before. It's a cashier's check.

CHERYL ANN *(inspecting it)*
Endorse it over to me.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
It's for fourteen hundred.

CHERYL ANN
You give me the check and I'll give you four hundred dollars.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Even better.

(MUSIC. She hands him the check and the cash.)

Scene 9: A Firing Range, FBI Training Ground, Quantico, VA

(As YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR leaves with CHERYL ANN, HANRATTY and the FBI agents enter. HANRATTY takes aim and fires.)

BRANTON
Hanratty, why the hell'd you drag us out to Quantico? This guy's a pen and ink man. A paperhanger. He probably doesn't even carry a gun.

HANRATTY
We're getting closer to this guy and you need to bone up on some of the skills you've let slide sitting in that basement sipping peppermint schnapps out of your coffee cup.

BRANTON
But we can't fix a location on him. One day he's in Dallas. The next he's in Stuttgart. Rome. Barcelona.

COD
He's gone global. The last bad checks came from Liechtenstein. Where the hell is Liechtenstein?

HANRATTY
The principality of Liechtenstein is a landlocked alpine country in Western Europe bordered by Switzerland to the west and south and Austria to the east. And if our UnSub thinks he can hide there he's sorely mistaken.

BRANTON
It's just forgery, Hanratty. There's no way the Bureau's gonna give us travel money for Liechtenwhatsit.

HANRATTY
This guy's just a forger like Mickey Mantle is just a hitter. He's not playing the game, boys. He's making the rules. No. No. He's a true talent.

COD
Geez, Hanratty. You want to arrest him or hire him?

HANRATTY
I see him in my sleep. Sixtyish, salt-and-pepper, tall. He's Old School, a virtuoso. He's been honing his craft for years. Years I tell you. But they always make a mistake. It's the overconfidence. Or the wine. Or the women.

(Bullets WHIZ and DING and they duck for cover.)

BRANTON
What the hell!

DOLLAR *(entering)*
You know, if shooting people is anything like target practice, it's very disappointing. I didn't feel a thing.

HANRATTY
Judas Priest, Dollar! This job is not about shooting at people. It's not about punching the clock waiting for retirement, or sneaking with the secretaries on three. This job is about just one guy. Frank Taylor a.k.a. Frank Williams a.k.a. William Franklin. He's out there somewhere, he is toying with me. He is taunting me.

COD
C’mon, Hanratty. He doesn’t even know you exist.

HANRATTY
He will. Believe it. He will.

BRANTON
Okay, okay. Stay cool.

HANRATTY
I will not stay cool. I have never been cool and I don’t intend to start now.

BRANTON
Hanratty, were you always like this?

BREAKING ALL THE RULES

HANRATTY
Long as I can remember. I think I was born this way. Other kids wanted to play cops and robbers. I only wanted to play cops. *(OLDER FRANK JUNIOR appears ...)*

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Ladies and gentlemen ... Carl Hanratty.

HANRATTY

IT STARTS VERY EARLY
ONCE THE BABY TOYS ARE GONE
A KID ON THE PLAYGROUND
HAS TO CHOOSE WHAT SIDE HE'S ON

IT'S THE BULLIES OR THE GOOD GUYS BOY,
THERE IS NO MIDDLE GROUND
THOUGH HOODLUMS TRY TO BLUR THE LINE
AND TWIST THE TRUTH AROUND

THEN THEY CALL THEMSELVES A WINNER
BUT THEY'RE SELF-DECEIVING FOOLS
'CAUSE THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING
IF YOU'RE BREAKING ALL THE RULES

THE LAW IS LAYED UPON US
WHEN AS KIDS WE FIRST ASK "WHY?"
OUR PARENTS SET THE RULES
WHEN "'CAUSE I SAID SO," THEY REPLY

AND THOUGH I THOUGHT I HATED THEM
AND SCREAMED WITH ALL MY MIGHT
THE NEXT TIME THAT I HAD A CHOICE
GEE WHIZ! I DID WHAT'S RIGHT

NO, I NEVER SNUCK A DRINK
I NEVER STOLE A PACK OF "KOOLS"
'CAUSE THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING

IF YOU'RE BREAKING ALL THE RULES

HANRATTY

OR ELSE WE'RE LIVING
IN THE WILD, WILD WEST

GOD'S KEEPING SCORE
AND YOU DON'T WANNA FAIL THAT TEST

YOU THUMB YOUR NOSE
RIGHT AT THE LIFE FOR WHICH I STRIVE

BUT THOSE RULES, THOSE LAWS
KEEP US ALIVE.

IT STARTED BACK WITH MOSES WHEN HE
LED AROUND THE JEWS

AND CLIMBED WAY UP THAT MOUNTAIN
TO PICK UP GOD'S DAILY NEWS

HE SCHLEPPED UP OLD MT. SINAI CRIED
AND BEGGED ON THEIR BEHALF

HE ALMOST DROPPED THOSE TABLETS
WHEN HE SAW THAT GOLDEN CALF

NOW WE TEACH THE TEN
COMMANDMENTS
EVERY SUNDAY IN OUR SCHOOLS

'CAUSE THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING
IF YOU'RE BREAKING ALL THE RULES

I GUESS
THE CONSTITUTION, BOYS,
TO SOME IS TOO COMPLEX

THEY THINK
OUR FOUNDING FATHERS FOUGHT
SO THEY COULD FORGE SOME CHECKS

THEY SEE THEMSELVES
AS ROBIN HOOD STEALING FROM THE
RICH

NOT PAYING BACK
THE THINGS THEY TAKE
WELL PAYBACK IS THE HITCH

'CAUSE THE WORLD AIN'T SHERWOOD
FOREST
YOU CAN'T GIVE AWAY THOSE JEWELS

AGENTS
DON'T BREAK THE RULES

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

THOSE RULES, THOSE LAWS
KEEP US ALIVE.

THE JEWS

TELL ME THE NEWS

OH LORD!

WHAT?

EVERY SUNDAY IN OUR SCHOOLS

AND BABY …
I GUESS …

THEY THINK

THEY SEE THEMSELVES

DON'TCHA KNOW THEY'RE NOT PAYING
BACK

POW!!!

YOU CAN'T GIVE AWAY THOSE JEWELS

AND THE GAME AIN’T WORTH WINNING IF
YOU’RE BREAKING ALL THE RULES

OR ELSE WE’RE LIVING IN THE WILD, WILD
WEST

GOD’S KEEPING SCORE
AND YOU DON’T WANNA FAIL THAT TEST

YOU THUMB YOUR NOSE
RIGHT AT THE LIFE FOR WHICH I STRIVE

BUT THOSE RULES, THOSE LAWS
KEEP US ALIVE!

WHEN YOU STEAL SOMEBODY’S MONEY
KISS HIS DAUGHTER OR HIS WIFE

YOU DON’T THINK OF REPERCUSSIONS AS
YOU TAP DANCE THROUGH YOUR LIFE

THOUGH YOU SMILE LIKE YOU’RE A HERO
YOU’RE AN OUTLAW

BUT THE ODDS ARE IN MY FAVOR, MAN
AND ONE DAY I’LL CATCH YOU

SO, GO SNEAK INTO A MOVIE
RUN A RED LIGHT, SELL SOME POT

IT’S ALL THE SAME TO ME
YOU’RE EITHER GUILTY OR YOU’RE NOT

IF WE ALL DID WHAT WE WANTED EVERY
TIME WE FELT THE URGE

THE WORLD WOULD BE IN TOTAL CHAOS
IT’S ALREADY ON THE VERGE

‘CAUSE, IT’S LAWS THAT KEEP US HUMAN
‘CAUSE WITHOUT THEM
WE’RE JUST MULES AND
THE GAME AIN’T WORTH WINNING I SAY
THE GAME AIN’T WORTH WINNING
OH OH OH
THE GAME AIN’T WORTH WINNING
IF YOU’RE BREAKING ALL THE RULES

OR ELSE WE’RE LIVING IN THE WILD, WILD
WEST

GOD’S KEEPING SCORE
AND YOU DON’T WANNA FAIL THAT TEST

DON’T BREAK THE RULES

DON’T BREAK THE RULES

DON’T BREAK THE RULES

BUT THOSE RULES, THOSE LAWS
KEEP US ALIVE!
US ALIVE!
OOH-OOH

WOP
OOH-OOH

BOP!
OOH-OOH
YOU’RE AN OUTLAW THROUGH AND
THROUGH

AND ONE DAY I’LL CATCH YOU

SO, GO SNEAK

DOO-WOP, DOO-WOP!

DOO-WOP, DOO-WOP, WOW!

THE WORLD WOULD BE IN TOTAL CHAOS

BOP!

‘CAUSE WITHOUT THEM WE’RE JUST
MULES
THE GAME AIN’T WORTH WINNING
THE GAME AIN’T WORTH WINNING

THE GAME AIN’T WORTH WINNING

DON’T BREAK THE RULES

DON’T BREAK THE RULES

DON’T BREAK THE RULES

YOU THUMB YOUR NOSE
AT THE LIFE FOR WHICH I STRIVE
THOSE LAWS
THOSE LAWS, BABY

KEEP US ALIVE!

BUT THOSE RULES THOSE LAWS
THOSE RULES THOSE LAWS
THOSE RULES THOSE LAWS

KEEP US ALIVE!
BOP!

HANRATTY
All right, back to work. Crime doesn't take a holiday.

(The FBI Agents scatter. YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR enters with his suitcase. A lovely STEWARDESS enters with a clipboard.)

Scene 10: Two hallways

STEWARDESS JANE
Good morning, First Officer. Are you my deadhead today?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Yes, ma'am. Been on the same equipment all week, jumpin' puddles for the weak and weary.

STEWARDESS JANE
First class is full, but I've got the jump seat open. Come on aboard.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Thanks!

STEWARDESS JANE
Be sure to watch out for that Skywayman.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Skywayman?

(The Stewardess hands him a newspaper, opened and folded to an article. He scans it. Branton and Dollar enter opposite.)

BRANTON
You're dangerous, kid. Who the hell taught you to shoot?

DOLLAR
My daddy taught me how to turn a mister into a missus at a hundred yards.

BRANTON
Yeah ... I don't really want to know about that.

(HANRATTY enters, and COD follows him in, with a flyer in hand.)

COD
Hanratty. I'm gonna regret this, but look at this field bulletin.

(HANRATTY grabs and scans it.)

HANRATTY + YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR *(overlapping; not in unison)*
The Skywayman. All the airlines are after him ... posing as an airline pilot ... flying all over the world

STEWARDESS JANE
They don't know how he does it.

COD
Maybe he forged some credentials?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
The Skywayman.

HANRATTY
Maybe he's a master con artist.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Like a superhero.

HANRATTY
Maybe ... he drops rubber everywhere he goes.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Crazy world we live in. I'll have to look out for him.

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR gives the paper back to the STEWARDESS and exits. She follows.)

HANRATTY
Nice work, Cod. All right, boys. We're checking every airport hotel, motel, cafe, and commissary on the Eastern seaboard. We just became front page news.

(HANRATTY and the boys exit and we go right to the Latin Quarter.)
(A floor show is just finishing, with the girls dressed in pinstripes.)

Scene 11: The Latin Quarter, NYC

FRANK SENIOR
This place ... something else. They have a guy to give towels to the guy who gives you towels.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I heard about it in Paris. I thought it might be just the place to take you when I got back to the States.

FRANK SENIOR
My son the birdman. Where're you flying that plane tonight?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Well, I don't really fly. I'm sort of just a copilot.

FRANK SENIOR
Where?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Los Angeles.

FRANK SENIOR
Hollywood.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Yeah.

FRANK SENIOR
Look at us, Frankie. On top of the world.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Dad. I went by the store today.

FRANK SENIOR
I had to close the store for a while. It's all a matter of timing, Frank. The goddamn government knows that, they hit you when you're down. I wasn't going to let them take it from me. So I just shut the doors myself. Called their bluff. Sooner or later, they'll forget about me.

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR slides a thick envelope across the table.)

FRANK SENIOR
What's this?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Let's open up the store, Dad. Pay off the Feds. Get things back the way they were. I can help out now.

FRANK SENIOR
Keep it. You got your own worries.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I'm fine. There's plenty more where this came from, believe me.

FRANK SENIOR
That's fine, Frankie. Take good care of yourself.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
But maybe if Mom saw —

FRANK SENIOR
Do I look like I need your help? *(A moment. To an invisible waiter:)* Double Bourbon! *(Back to YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR.)* Don't worry about your mom and me. She's stubborn, always has been. She's a formidable woman. But I won't let her go without a fight.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
If she saw you had the store back —

FRANK SENIOR
Two hundred soldiers in that tiny social hall, watching her dance. I didn't speak a word of French. And six weeks later, she was my wife.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
She could be again.

FRANK SENIOR
I don't know, Frankie.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Listen, Dad, everything's different now. I got this great job. I make lots of money. I can have breakfast in Rome, lunch in Miami, and dinner in San Francisco. I can snap my fingers ...*(He raises his hand, snaps his fingers twice. MUSIC.)*… and strike up an orchestra.

FRANK SENIOR
And here I thought you were just a copilot.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I can be anything you need me to be. Because I learned from the best.

BUTTER OUTTA CREAM

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
REMEMBER THAT STORY I LEARNED AT YOUR FEET
WELL NOW IT'S MY TURN, TAKE A SEAT

TWO LITTLE MICE OF GREAT RENOWN
FELL IN SOME MILK AND ONE PROCEEDED TO DROWN
THE OTHER ONE'S STILL THE TOAST OF THE TOWN
CAUSE HE MADE BUTTER OUTTA CREAM

HE LOOKED AROUND, DEDUCED HIS PLIGHT
SAID "THIS IS NO WAY TO SPEND A SATURDAY NIGHT!"
BUT HE HAD THE STYLE TO MAKE THINGS RIGHT
SO HE MADE BUTTER OUTTA CREAM

HE KICKED HIS LEGS UP HE TOSSED AND TURNED
SO NOT TO END UP A GHOST
HE DID THE HOKEY-POKEY TILL THE CREAM WAS CHURNED
THEN BABY, HE WALKED RIGHT OUT AND BUTTERED HIS TOAST

NOW HE'S ON TOP FOR GOODNESS SAKES
YEAH, HE'S THE BIG CHEESE UP AT "LAND O' LAKES"
HE'S LIVING PROOF THAT POP ALL IT TAKES IS A SCHEME
SO IF YOU LAND IN THE GUTTER JUST MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM
Your turn, Dad.

FRANK SENIOR
Nah—you're doing great.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
This is a duet. It's Frank and Dean. It's not a solo act.

FRANK SENIOR
Well, you know ... there is one you haven't told you.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Really?

FRANK SENIOR.
THERE WAS A COCKROACH IN BRAZIL
GOT DRUNK AT THE LOCAL COFFEE MILL
HE THOUGHT HIS TIME WAS UP UNTIL

HE MADE COFFEE OUTTA BEANS

WHEN HE CAME TO HE HEARD SUCH A SOUND
MUCH TO HIS SHOCK WHEN HE LOOKED AROUND
HE HAD BEEN SCOOPED AND WAS ABOUT TO BE GROUND
SO, HE MADE COFFEE OUT OF BEANS

HE MARCHED TO THE SOUTH
AND HE STOMPED TO THE NORTH
HE HAD TO RACE AGAINST FATE
HE DID THE CUCARACHA WHILE THOSE TEARS POURED FORTH
THEN SEÑOR, THINGS BEGAN TO PERCOLATE

HE HELD HIS BREATH AND SWAM TO THE TOP
HE BORROWED BEANS FROM HIS MOM AND POP
AND OPENED UP HIS OWN COFFEE SHOP OUT IN QUEENS!
WHEN HIS LIGHTS WERE ALMOST OFF
HE JUST MADE COFFEE OUTTA BEANS

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Let's bring this one home, Dad!

FRANK SENIOR
All right, Son!

BOTH
SO THINK OF THOSE TWO WHEN LIFE'S THE PITS

FRANK SENIOR
"THE BUG"

FRANK JUNIOR
AND "THE MOUSE"

BOTH
AT THE END OF THEIR WITS
THEY KNEW THE KEY TO LIFE IS THAT
ITS WHA' CHA DREAM
SO IF LEMONS CLOG YOUR SINK UP
DON'T JUST STAND AROUND AND SCREAM
SPIKE SOME LEMONADE AND DRINK UP
AND MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM

FRANK SENIOR
JUST MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
MAKE SOME BUTTER OUT OF CREAM

FRANK SENIOR
I HEAR WHAT YOU'RE SAYING, SON
I'LL MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM!

Scene 12: Idlewild Airport Motel, Room 135, Paula's New Home, Frank's room somewhere

(HANRATTY, COD, and DOLLAR inspect a much-used motel room: comic books, junk-food containers, crumpled papers. BRANTON appears at the door.)

BRANTON
Hanratty! The manager says he just checked out three hours ago. Was here for almost a week. No forwarding.

COD
Looks like he left in a hurry.

HANRATTY
Okay fellows. Impress me. *(They begin to pore over the room, opening drawers, lifting cushions, inspecting furniture.)* Mister Taylor, real name unknown, left us a goldmine.

DOLLAR *(holds up a comic book)*
The Flash. He likes comic books.

COD *(holds up a pizza box and a jar of peanut butter)*
He lives on junk food.

COD
Oh my god! It's Hanratty!

HANRATTY
That's funny, Cod. That's very funny. I'll make a note to laugh later, when you're dead. Come on, people. What's his next move? What goes on in the mind of an obsessive loner?

BRANTON
Why don't you tell us?

(Hanratty glares at Branton, then picks up the wastebasket, and dumps the contents on the floor.)

HANRATTY
A man's secrets are in his trash. *(The other agents look at the trash, then at Hanratty.)*

BRANTON
I'll take your word for it.

HANRATTY
Branton, Cod, go canvas the other guests. Dollar, get license plate numbers on every car in the lot. I'll process the room.

COD *(as the men leave)*
Right. Say, Hanratty. You ever look at your own garbage?
(The other agents go.)

[SFX: 9)The Man Inside the Clues]

HANRATTY
No, no, no. Something doesn't jive here. The Flash? Peanut butter? Maybe he's got a kid? *(HANRATTY goes to work, picking through the garbage.)* All right, Mister Taylor. I know you're in here somewhere.

THE MAN INSIDE THE CLUES

HANRATTY
A COMIC BOOK, A MISS JULY, A MATCHBOOK FROM "THE FLAME"
SOME CHEWING GUM, A MISMATCHED PAIR OF SHOES
A LETTER HOME THAT WASN'T MAILED
A CHECK WITHOUT A NAME
YEAH, THEY'LL BE MY GUIDE TO THE MAN INSIDE THE CLUES

(Lights on YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR, in another hotel room, on the phone. A RING. Elsewhere, JACK BARNES and PAULA, in night clothes. PAULA on the phone.)

PAULA
Hello? Hello? Frankie is that you?

JACK BARNES
Is it him again?

PAULA
Frankie?

JACK BARNES
Paula, give me the phone.

PAULA
Frankie, are you there?

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR abruptly hangs up. PAULA looks at JACK and shakes her head.)

HANRATTY
A BOBBY PIN, TWO BASEBALL CARDS
SOME DAY-OLD CHINESE FOOD
TWO TICKET STUBS, THE RED SOX ALWAYS LOSE
A VALENTINE THAT WASN'T SENT
A SCENT TO SET THE MOOD
WHEN I TAKE A RIDE
WITH THE MAN INSIDE THE CLUES

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR *(overlapping)*
Hi Miss Room Service, I'd like to place an order. I know it's late—I just flew in from Ireland. Have you been there? It's so beautiful—oh, yeah, sure. I'll hold.

HANRATTY
DO NOT DISTURB IS ON THE DOOR
THE MAID, SHE NEVER COMES
HE LOCKED THE DOOR BUT I DON'T NEED A KEY

THERE'S ONLY GARBAGE ON THE FLOOR
TO OTHERS, THEY'RE JUST CRUMBS
THOSE CRUMBS LOOK LIKE
A FIVE-COURSE MEAL TO ME

I USE MY HEAD TO GET IN HIS

SO I CAN THINK LIKE HIM
I SEE HE FLIES AND ALSO CRIES THE BLUES
BUT IF I LOOK INSIDE MYSELF
MY DREAMS ARE GROWING DIM
YES IT'S BEST TO HIDE
WITH THE MAN INSIDE THE CLUES

YOUNGER FRANK JUNIOR
How can it be disconnected? Just last week I, could you look again? It's A-B-A-G-N-A-L-E. Senior.

(The other agents return.)

BRANTON
Anything?

HANRATTY *(hands him a crumpled sheet of paper)*
Pan Am stationery. "As a Pan Am pilot, my family flies for free. The two of you should come out to Los Angeles with me. Maybe then --" Unfinished.

BRANTON
The two of who?

HANRATTY
Who knows? But we know he's going to Los Angeles. And so are we.

DOLLAR
Fantastic.

COD
Now that's the best idea he's had yet.

BRANTON
He could use the sun. If he were any more pale, he'd be transparent.

(The men exit. HANRATTY moves to follow, but stops, and returns to the room.)

HANRATTY
I'VE LOOKED INTO SO MANY LIVES
BUT NEVER AT MY OWN
THE TRAIL I LEFT IS SUCH A DAMN CLICHÉ

THE LONELY WIFE, THE HOUSE FOR SALE
A MILLION NIGHTS ALONE
TO WISH YOU HAD THE THINGS YOU THREW AWAY ...
LIKE A FRONT DOOR KEY A HOME COOKED MEAL
THE HAPPY BRIDE AND GROOM
THEN LIFE KICKS IN AND MAKES YOU PAY YOUR DUES

AND THEN YOU FIND YOU'RE BY YOURSELF
IN A SINGLE MOTEL ROOM THAT'S BEEN OCCUPIED
BY THE MAN INSIDE THE CLUES
THE MAN INSIDE THE CLUES.

Scene 13: A Motel in Los Angeles

Blackout. Motel room view and furniture change to show we are somewhere else. HANRATTY and men in the nearby lobby with the MOTEL MANAGER. We see YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR laying on his bed in his room, listening to the radio.

RADIO ANNOUNCEMENT
KRLA … It's currently a summer sixty-five degrees here in Los Angeles …

MOTEL MANAGER
He wrote three checks. They all cleared. I was gonna deposit this one today. I don't want any trouble.

HANRATTY
There won't be any trouble. I'll just take this check and be on my way.

MOTEL MANAGER
Good. I don't want my customers harassed.

HANRATTY
You mean he's still here?

MOTEL MANAGER *(hesitates)*
Two-oh-one.

HANRATTY
I take the lead. You guys back me up. Dollar takes the exit. *(HANRATTY draws his gun. DOLLAR eagerly follows suit.)* Put it away. *(DOLLAR complies, glumly.)* If you're good little boys, I'll buy you all a Good Humor bar.

MOTEL MANAGER
You said there wouldn't be any trouble.

HANRATTY
Relax, mister, you'll get one, too. *(HANRATTY proceeds, cautiously, gun drawn, to room 201. The rest exit, in other directions. HANRATTY bursts in through the door ...)* F.B.I.! *(... but the room is empty. HANRATTY slowly moves in, looking over a bureau and table filled with the implements of forgery. From the bathroom, a toilet flushing sound. HANRATTY points his gun.)* F.B.I.! Come out with your hands on your head.

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR calmly emerges from the bathroom, beard in his face, a hat pretty low. Nods at HANRATTY.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Guy's got a MICR encoder, can you believe that?

HANRATTY
Don't move. Put your hands on your head or I'll shoot.
(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR half-ignores the gun pointed at him and walks to the desk.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
He's got about two hundred checks here—a gallon of India ink, drafting glue—he even makes little payroll envelopes addressed to himself from Pan Am.

HANRATTY
Keep your hands where I can see them.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Relax, buddy, you’re late. The name's Allen, Barry Allen, United States Secret Service. Your man just tried to climb out the window—my partner has him in custody downstairs.

HANRATTY
What are you talking about? Keep your hands on your head.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
You think the F.B.I. are the only ones tracking this guy? He’s been dabbling in government checks. We’ve been following a paper trail for months. We almost had him in New York, then in a motel outside D.C. near Dulles airport. Would you mind taking that gun out of my face? It makes me nervous.

HANRATTY
Let me see some identification.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Here, take my whole wallet. You want my gun, too? *(throws wallet on bed)*

HANRATTY
No, no. I wasn’t expecting Secret Service on this.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Don’t worry about it. What’s your name, anyway?

HANRATTY
Hanratty. Carl Hanratty.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
You mind if I see some ID, Carl?

HANRATTY
Sure.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIORS
Can’t be too careful these days.

HANRATTY
Sure, sorry. I’m just a little …*(HANRATTY indicates nerves with his hands.)* Here. Right here. *(HANRATTY hands YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR his business card)*

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Tough luck, Carl. Five minutes earlier and you would have landed yourself a pretty good collar.

HANRATTY
That’s okay, ten seconds later you would have been shot. *(They laugh, then stop laughing. YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR goes to a pitcher of water and pours himself a drink — and only we can see he's trembling.)* Hey, let me ask you something. What does he look like?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
He's a handsome son of a gun.

HANRATTY
Yeah? I had him figured for an older guy.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
He is pretty damn old. He must be your age at least.

HANRATTY
Okay. I asked for that one!

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Just do me a favor. Sit tight a minute while I get some of this evidence downstairs. I don't want anyway walking through my crime scene.

HANRATTY
Sure. *(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR picks up the MICR machine and heads for the door.)*

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
You know, some maid comes in here and starts making the bed. I hate when that happens.

HANRATTY
Wait.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
(freezes, turns) What?

HANRATTY
Your wallet.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Hang on to it till I come back for the rest of the stuff. I trust you.

HANRATTY
You shouldn't. *(a beat.)* That was a joke.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
You got me, Carl. (*he exits*)

HANRATTY
Nice guy. *(Then, unable to contain himself)* We got him! *(He does a little victory dance.)* I love my job. I love it, I love it, I love it. *(He stops. Thinks a minute. Opens the wallet. Fingers through the ID cards within.)* Frank Taylor. Frank Black. Frank Williams. Frank No!!!! *(The other three agents rush into the room.)*

COD
Where is he?

HANRATTY
I had him. He was right there!

BRANTON
What are you talking about?

HANRATTY

I let him convince me he was someone else. Barry Allen from the Secret Service.

DOLLAR
Barry Allen? The Flash?

HANRATTY
What?

DOLLAR
Barry Allen is the alter ego of the Flash.

HANRATTY
Oh, Jesus Christ.

DOLLAR
We all make mistakes, sir, it happens to the best of us.

HANRATTY
Not to me. Not to me.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(Downstage, to us)*
That was close, wasn't it? Misdirection. Maintain eye contact. Keep talking. *(He shrugs.)* Mister Hanratty and his men caught the next plane back to DC. And I ... I caught the one after that. I don't know why. I guess I always wanted to see our nation's capital at Christmas. The best time of the year.

Scene 14: A Hotel Room and the FBI Building, both Washington, DC

CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR (PARTY VERSION)

(The Stewardesses party as YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR looks on.)

PARTYGOERS
ANGELS SING, THE SOUND'S SUBLIME
LISTEN TO THOSE CHURCH BELLS CHIME
CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

(A few of the Stewardesses approach YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR.)

LINDY
What's the matter, honey?

CINDY
You look pooped!

MINDY
You need a good long layover.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I'm just going to get some air.

(The STEWARDESSES and PILOTS dance off as we transition to HANRATTY's office. He's poring over documents with a loupe. BRANTON enters.)

BRANTON

Hanratty, come on. It's Christmas Eve. You're not going to redeem yourself with the boys upstairs by having a miserable holiday.

HANRATTY
You're wrong. *(checks his watch without looking up)* It's not Christmas Eve. It's Christmas.

BRANTON
You want me to stay?

HANRATTY
No. You've got kids. Go home.

BRANTON
Merry Christmas, Hanratty

(He goes. HANRATTY's phone RINGS. He picks up.)

[SFX: 10b)Phone Ring]

HANRATTY
This is Hanratty. Merry Christmas.

(Lights on YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR at a pay phone.)

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Hello, Carl.

HANRATTY
Who is this?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I've been trying to track you down. Merry Christmas.

HANRATTY
Barry Allen, Secret Service! What do you want?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I want to apologize for what happened out in Los Angeles.

HANRATTY
Yeah? Screw you.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Carl, I'm sorry if I made a fool out of you.

HANRATTY
Goddamn it, you don't feel sorry for me. The fact is, I knew it was you. I did. Maybe I didn't pull the trigger but I knew.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
People only know what you tell them.

HANRATTY
Then tell me something: how did you know I wouldn't look in your wallet?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I didn't.

HANRATTY
You're gonna get caught, you know that, don't you? One way or another. Just like Vegas—the house always wins.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I didn't think I'd get you in. It's Christmas. I thought maybe you had a family?

HANRATTY
No. No family.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Me either.

MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

HANRATTY
YEAH, DON'TCHA LOVE THE YULETIDE FUN
THERE'S JOY AND CHEER FOR EVERYONE
I WAIT FOR SANTA WITH A GUN
YES, CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
SOME SUGAR PLUMS I HAVEN'T KISSED
BUT MISTLETOE I MUST RESIST
CAUSE I'M ON ST. CARL'S MOST WANTED LIST

BOTH
YES, CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

(Lights on FRANK SENIOR and PAULA, separately.)

HANRATTY, YOUNG FRANK JR, FRANK SR, PAULA
AND THERE'S A HOME WHERE YOU CAN'T GO
AND THERE'S A LIFE THAT'S FULL OF LOVE
YOU USED TO KNOW

HANRATTY
FOR ME IT'S TRUE

FRANK SENIOR
BUT KID, NOT YOU

PAULA
CAUSE YOUR FAMILY'S HERE

FRANK SENIOR & PAULA
YEAH, THEY'RE STILL YOURS TO HOLD
IF YOU …

FRANK SENIOR & PAULA & HANRATTY

COME IN FROM THE COLD

HANRATTY
SO, IF TOMORROW SANTA'S FLOWN
THE TREE IS DOWN AND YOU'RE ALONE
I'M ALWAYS HERE, RIGHT BY THE PHONE

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR & HANRATTY
YES CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

HANRATTY
Wait a minute. Wait a minute. You didn't call me to apologize, did you?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
What do you mean?

HANRATTY
You've got no one else to talk to.

FRANK JUNIOR *(half beat)*
I have to go.

HANRATTY
Frank! Wait!

(YOUNGER FRANK JUNIOR almost hangs up the phone. But stops. While HANRATTY waits on the other end of the phone, OLDER FRANK JUNIOR appears.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Mister Hanratty was right. It was a lonely life. But I was about to meet someone, and she was gonna change everything. Everything. But right now ... Tonight ...

HANRATTY
Frank?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I'm still here.

HANRATTY
Sooner or later you'll get tired of running.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Sooner or later you'll get tired of chasing me.

HANRATTY
No I won't.

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
Look out the window.

HANRATTY
Why?

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR

Just do it.

I'LL CALL YOU SOON, BUT WHO KNOWS WHEN

HANRATTY

AND, FRANK, I HOPE WE'LL MEET AGAIN
LIKE WHEN YOU'RE SERVING EIGHT TO TEN

BOTH

YES, CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

(YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR jumps off the stage and disappears up the aisle of the theatre.)

HANRATTY (to himself) (to us)
He's a kid. He's a kid.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

Scene 1: The FBI Building, Washington, DC

(As the Entre' Acte ends, we see HANRATTY and his three men, huddled in a hallway.)

HANRATTY
Look, it's simple. We know he's a kid. We find out who's responsible for the kid. So we check out every runaway teen and missing student in the tri-state area over the past three years. I pulled a list from the mainframe. We just go to each address and ask to see a family photo.

DOLLAR
How long will that take?

HANRATTY
As long as it takes. Let's go, men.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Good luck with that! Poor Agent Hanratty. I think that's gonna take a while. My career as a pilot was pretty much done, and I'd wrung out every bank in the Northeast, so it was time for me to lay low for a while, live off my savings. I moved to the Riverbend Apartments in Atlanta, Georgia, a real nice complex, full of professionals, the perfect place to keep things quiet.

Scene 2: The Riverbend Apartments and Atlanta General Hospital, Atlanta

(PARTY DOCTORS and NURSES enter at a stumbling run, drinks in hand.)

PARTY DOCTOR
Woo-hoo!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Of course, a few years later, Riverbend would be written up as the address for swinging singles. But for right now, I just had to keep a low profile. No more cons, no more high living, no more lies.

(The PARTY DOCTOR approaches OLDER FRANK JUNIOR)

PARTY DOCTOR
So, Frank, what brings you to the Riverbend complex? I thought it was just us doctors and nurses here.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Oh. Well. You know. I'm a doctor. *(He shoots us a despairing look.)*

PARTY DOCTOR
What do you do, surgery? Orthopedics?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Pediatrics?

PARTY DOCTOR
Snot-nosed little kids? You can have 'em. Listen, I'll find out if there's anything open down at Atlanta General. Be great to have you there! *(He goes.)*

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Oh, no, thank you, I ...*(OLDER FRANK JUNIOR turns to us.)* What am I doing? I can't be a doctor. Why do I do this every time?

(Some NURSES pass)

Oh yeah. Ladies and gentlemen—nurses.

(They walk by him and wave)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
How am I going to get through this? Medicine? But, now that I think of it, Ben Casey always made it look easy on television. *(He snaps his fingers and a BEN CASEY episode appears. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR watches as BEN CASEY makes a diagnosis, standing over a patient with another doctor.*)

BEN CASEY
I think what we have here is advanced third-degree encephelomarginalia. Do you concur, doctor?

OTHER DOCTOR
Yes, I concur. What do you recommend, Doctor Casey?

BEN CASEY
Let's not jump to any conclusions. We'll run every test we can. We'll find out what's ailing you, son.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
(clicks it off, speaks to us) That's gonna come in handy. I could pick up a few books at the Emory bookstore. But there's the little matter of a med school degree — *(He's joined by DOCTOR WANAMAKER. Slightly doddering, he's the head of Atlanta General. He's inspecting a parchment document.)*

DOCTOR WANAMAKER
Harvard University! Very impressive, Doctor Connors. And you actually brought in your diploma.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(to us)*
Act Two is brought to you by parchment paper, calligraphy, and press-on-letters.

DOCTOR WANAMAKER
And we also have your recommendation from Death Valley Children's Hospital. Doctor ... Hanratty?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
He's my mentor.

DOCTOR WANAMAKER
You're just the perfect candidate.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I should mention, the sight of blood makes me vomit. *(WANAMAKER laughs. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR laughs. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR stops laughing and gives us a panicked look.)* No, seriously.

DOCTOR WANAMAKER
At the moment, the only thing open is overnight ER supervisor. Beneath a doctor of your qualifications, and you'd primarily be supervising residents and interns, so you wouldn't get much real patient contact—

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'll take it.

DOCTOR WANAMAKER
All right then. Welcome aboard.

(He goes, and the nurses come back.)

DOCTOR'S ORDERS

NURSE KELLY
HEY DOCTOR, ARE YOU ON CALL?
I'M NOT FEELING SO WELL AT ALL
I KEPT THINKING ABOUT YA
AS I COULD NOT SLEEP A WINK LAST NIGHT

NURSE SHELLIE
I TOSSED AND TURNED THE WHOLE NIGHT LONG
KEPT FEELING LIKE SOMETHING'S WRONG
I NEED A CHECKUP TO MAKE EVERYTHINGS ALL RIGHT

ALL NURSES
SO I ...

NURSE NELLIE
MADE THIS APPOINTMENT
AND I CLEARED YOUR AFTERNOON

ALL NURSES
YES, I ...

NURSE KELLY
NEED ME A LITTLE "T.L.C."

KELLY, SHELLIE, NELLIE, SHERRIE
AND I GOTTA GET SOME SOON ...

ALL NURSES
LET ME TELL YA THAT

NURSE TERRI
MAYBE I NEVER LISTENED GOOD
I NEVER DID THE THINGS I SHOULD
BUT I'M READY TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS!

NURSE KERRIE
MAYBE, I NEVER FELT SO BAD
I NEED SOMETHING I NEVER HAD AND I'M READY ...
TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS!

ALL NURSES
OOH OOH ...
(The Nurses leave him.)

BRENDA

Doctor Connors! Doctor Connors!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
The minute I saw her, I knew. I just knew. About her, that is. About the medicine, still a little…you know…

INTERN 1
Doctor Connors, patient reports intense abdominal pain and pressure, difficulty breathing. Abdomen distended. Indicates acute appendicitis.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Do you concur doctor?

INTERN 2
Um. Yes? I concur?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
And what do you recommend?

INTERN 2
Um, Getting a surgeon? To take his appendix out?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
All right then. Piece of cake. Wait! Nurse!

NURSE CINDY	NURSES
HEY DOCTOR, I NEED REPAIR, I NEED INTENSE INTENSIVE CARE I BETTER TAKE HEED OF THE SURGEON GENERAL'S WARNING	OF THE SURGEON GENERAL'S WARNING
NURSE MINDY	
AND IF YOU'RE TIRED AND LOOKING PALE I'LL BE YOUR FLORENCE NIGHTINGALE AND IF ONE WON'T DO THEN PLEASE TAKE TWO AND CALL US IN THE MORNING	I'LL BE YOUR FLORENCE NIGHTINGALE
NURSES	
YES I, LIKED PLAYING DOCTOR WAS MY FAVORITE GAME INDOORS AND I WOULD LIKE TO DO MY JOB IF I COULD JUST GET YOU TO DO YOURS	
NURSE LINDY	
MAYBE I NEED A REMEDY, DOC, IT'S AN EMERGENCY. SO I'M READY TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS!	
NURSE JANE	
MAYBE I NEED THE ANTIDOTE YOU'RE THE ONE IN THAT WHITE LAB COAT YES I'M READY TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS	READY OOH

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Nurse, I've said hello to you four times a day over eleven days and you've never once stopped to have a conversation. It is me?

BRENDA
Oh, no, Dr. Connors! All the nurses love you. They talk about it in the nurse's lounge. I just – I mean, I never – I mean, I try not to talk because I always talk too much and if I talked to you I would probably end up saying something embarrassing about how handsome you are and – I need to stop talking now.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
No – don't.

INTERN 1
Dr. Connors! MVA, car versus bike. Should we set it or get a surgical consult?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Let's not jump to any conclusions, Nurse Strong. We'll run every test we can.

INTERN
He's got a bone sticking out of his leg.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Yes ... Doctor ... I, uh ... I ... concur! I concur! Just go! *(struggling not to get sick, makes eye contact, then they start to laugh like teenagers)* Hey – there's a smile. You've got braces. That's good. I had braces, I still have my retainer. See?

BRENDA
You have beautiful teeth. I really admire your teeth… I should go.

NURSE KELLY	NURSES
I KNOW WHAT THEY SAY	AHH ...
ABOUT AN APPLE A DAY	
TO BE THE STRONGEST GAL IN TOWN...	OOH…
BUT IF AN APPLE A DAY	
KEEPS THE DOCTOR AWAY	OOH…
I'M GONNA BURN THAT	I'M GONNA BURN
THAT ORCHARD DOWN	THAT ORCHARD DOWN!
NURSE SHELLIE	
MAYBE DON'T STOP UNTIL I'M HEALED	OOH OOH ...
I'VE GOT BLUE CROSS	
AND I'VE GOT BLUE SHIELD	
I'M READY	READY
TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS	DOCTOR'S ORDERS
NURSE NELLIE	
MAYBE, TAKE OUT THAT STETHOSCOPE	
YOU MAY BE MY ONLY HOPE	
SO I'M READY	READY
TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS	DOCTOR'S ORDERS

NURSE SHELLIE
MAYBE YOU BETTER OPERATE
THEN TO MIAMI TO RECUPERATE
YES I'M READY
TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS

OOH OOH

READY
DOCTOR'S ORDERS

NURSE KERRI
OXYGEN PLEASE,
CAN'T CATCH MY BREATH
DOCTOR YOU GOT THE KISS OF DEATH
AND I'M READY

OOH OOH ...

SOME NURSES
READY
READY
COME ON, LET'S ROCK STEADY
READY
FOR DOCTOR'S ORDERS
WOO!

OTHER NURSES
READY
READY
COME ON, LET'S ROCK STEADY
READY
FOR DOCTOR'S ORDERS
WOO!

(The doctors and nurses exit. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR falls into an exhausted heap. BRENDA enters.)

BRENDA
Doctor Conners? Doctor Conners?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(wakes with a start)*
Oh, I was ... uh ... I haven't been getting much sleep at the apartment these days.

BRENDA
Doctor Conners, do you know which patient gets the O-Negative?*(She holds up a blood bag, dark red in translucent plastic. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR takes one look and turns and clutches his stomach, groaning.)* Doctor?

NURSE TERRI
O-negative! O-negative! Who's got the O-negative? *(BRENDA holds it up and the nurse grabs it.)*

BRENDA
Are you okay?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Sorry ... just some bad tuna...at the cafeteria.

BRENDA
Is there anything I can do?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
You could have coffee with me.

BRENDA
But their coffee's worse than the tuna. Oh! You mean have a cup of coffee in a social way.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I guess I do. I've tried to start a conversation with you and you've barely even said hello.

BRENDA
I'm so sorry, Doctor Conners. Hello.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Hello.

BRENDA *(half beat)*
Goodbye. *(She moves to go.)*

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Nurse Strong!

BRENDA
I'm sorry, sir. They don't like us to fraternize with the doctors.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Pretend I'm not a doctor. Pretend I'm a pilot. Or an astronaut.

BRENDA
Oh, I don't think I could see you as a pilot. A playboy maybe.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'm not really in to all that Riverbend madness. It's just ... sort of a part I play.

BRENDA
So you're not really a skirt-chasing party animal, you just want people to think you are?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Well, yeah. I mean, no. I mean—wait.

BRENDA
Good day, Doctor Conners.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
You're very serious.

BRENDA
I'm just trying to do a good job, sir. I'm the youngest nurse here.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'm the youngest doctor here. And you're the best nurse we have.

BRENDA
Oh, no, no one ever listens to me. They're all so confident and sure of themselves and ... tall.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
If you want them to listen, you just have to sound like you know what you're talking about. Act like you have confidence, and pretty soon you will. Act like you're not afraid, and you won't be. Okay?

BRENDA
(smiles) Okay.

INTERN *(Two Interns enter at a run, with a gurney.)*

Doctor Conners, we've got a kitchen accident. Meat slicer. And they can't exactly find the hand ...

(OLDER FRANK JUNIOR starts to lose it. BRENDA steps up.)

BRENDA
Trauma One. I'll call surgery. Go! *(The Interns hurry off.)*

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
See? Look at you.

BRENDA
Thank you. Doctor Conners.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Call me Frank.

BRENDA
Okay. Frank. Oh! Surgery!

(She hurries off. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR watches her go. MUSIC. He sings.)

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR (REPRISE)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
NOW THE PICTURE SEEMS SO CLEAR
SHE'S ALIVE IN LIVING COLOR
SO EXCUSE ME WHILE I DISAPPEAR ...

(HANRATTY appears opposite, watching him.)

HANRATTY
Sooner or later, they always make a mistake.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Brenda wasn't a mistake.

HANRATTY
Sooner or later—

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(abruptly turns to us)*
Meanwhile, it's taking Agent Hanratty a really, really long time to visit the house of every single runaway in New York, New Jersey, and Connecticut.

HANRATTY *(overlapping, also to us)*
Actually, we cracked it pretty quickly—

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Mister Hanratty. It's my show.

HANRATTY
I interviewed your parents. You weren't there. You were busy with Brenda. Maybe this part is my show.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
All right. Fine.

HANRATTY
Sort of a ... film noir ... type of thing. Phillip Marlowe.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Sure.

(OLDER FRANK JUNIOR gestures: Have at it. And waits. HANRATTY turns to us.)

HANRATTY
It was hot, even for August. So hot my butt was sticking to the seat of my car like a fly on paper and my suit was my own personal sauna. But not as hot as the woman I was about to interview. She gave new meaning to the words femme fatale. Too bad she was some poor kid's mother.

(MUSIC. Paula enters, a few years older.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Ladies and Gentlemen, Paula Abagnale performs "Dancing Around the Subject".

Scene 3: The Barnes House and A Bar, New Rochelle

DON'T BE A STRANGER
PAULA
I haven't seen Frankie, since he ran away.
I ALWAYS KNEW I'D SEE THIS DAY, I CAN'T SAY IT'S A SHOCK
WHAT'S THAT EXPRESSION? QU'EST-CE QUE C'EST?
HE'S "A CHIP OFF THE OLD BLOCK"
BUT IF YOU SEE HIM PLEASE PASS ON THIS PLEA
DON'T BE A STRANGER -- TELL HIM THAT FOR ME

HANRATTY
If I could just look at a photo ...

PAULA
I don't have a recent one. Here ... his junior class yearbook ...

(She finds a yearbook and Hanratty grabs it.)

HANRATTY
That's him. Heavens to Betsy, that's him. *(reads from yearbook)* Class Treasurer?

PAULA
Is Frankie in some sort of trouble?

HANRATTY
Ma'am, your son's in a great deal of trouble. He has been passing bad checks, forging government documents—

PAULA
Well? So? Half of the kids his age are on dope but instead you chase after Frankie because he made a little mistake? Tant pis. Tell me how much he owes, I'll write you a check—

HANRATTY
So far it's one-point-four million dollars.

PAULA
Ce n'est pas possible.

HANRATTY
Oh, it's possible. Unlikely, but possible.

PAULA
It sounds like Frankie's good at this.

HANRATTY
Yes. If you wanted to raise a crook, you should be very proud.

PAULA
MY FRANKIE HAD A CLEVER MIND
HE COULD SPEND HOURS ALL ALONE
I WOULDN'T HAVE BEEN SURPRISED TO FIND
HE CHANGED HIS DIAPER ON HIS OWN
COULD I HAVE BEEN THERE MORE? WELL, C'EST LA VIE
DON'T BE A STRANGER -- TELL HIM THAT FOR ME

HANRATTY
You haven't heard from him since you left your husband?

PAULA
I'm to blame. Is that what you're saying?

HANRATTY
I don't do blame, ma'am. I just catch the bad guys.

PAULA
THOUGH I TRIED, I COULDN'T HIDE WHEN LOVE HAD FLOWN AWAY
CHILDREN CLOSE THEIR EYES BUT STILL THEY SEE
I TOOK A CHANCE, A NEW ROMANCE
IS IT A CRIME TO SAY
I MADE A CHOICE AND CHOSE WHAT'S BEST FOR ME

HANRATTY
Where might I locate your son?

PAULA
Ask his father. He says Frankie writes to him.

HANRATTY
And would I find his father?

PAULA
Check the bars in town.

HANRATTY
Okay then.

(Split scene: The Barnes living room splits the stage with a dive bar, FRANK SENIOR on a barstool.)

PAULA
HIS FATHER HAS A HEAD FOR DREAMS
BUT NOT THE MIDAS TOUCH
HIS FATHER HAS A MILLION SCHEMES
BUT DOLLARS? NOT SO MUCH
YOU WANT THE APPLE GO LOOK FOR THE TREE
AND DON'T BE A STRANGER. TELL HIM THAT FOR ME.

FRANK SENIOR
I USED TO HAVE WHAT MADE HER SMILE
BUT NOW IT'S ALL BEEN SPENT
I'VE TONS OF CHARM I'M LOUSY WITH STYLE
BUT IT DON'T PAY THE RENT
SO IF YOU SPOT HER OUT THERE ON A SPREE
TELL HER DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL HER THAT FOR ME

HANRATTY
She said she hasn't heard from Frank Junior since the divorce.

FRANK SENIOR
It was too much for Frankie, and it was all on her. All her.

HANRATTY
Okay.

FRANK SENIOR
I USED TO BE A PRINCE TO HER
THIS PRINCE HAS LOST HIS CROWN
I BROUGHT HER LAUGHS SHE WANTED FUR
NO WONDER LOVE FELL DOWN
ARREST THE CLOWN WHO SAID
THE BEST THINGS IN LIFE ARE FREE
THEN DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL HER THAT FOR ME

HANRATTY
Do you know where your son is?

FRANK SENIOR
ONE MORE ROUND AT THE LOST AND FOUND
THAT'S IF YOU GOT THE DOUGH
HAPPY HOUR IS SUDDENLY LAST CALL
MY EYES ARE DRY I SAID GOODBYE
SO MANY TEARS AGO

FRANK SENIOR + PAULA
THE PAST IS JUST A PHOTO ON THE WALL

FRANK SENIOR
I GUESS TO YOU I SEEM A SCHMUCK
WELL, I'LL JUST BIDE MY TIME

'CAUSE I BELIEVE THAT LADY LUCK
CAN STILL TURN ON A DIME

AND MAYBE ONE
WILL ONCE AGAIN BE THREE

DON'T BE A STRANGER –
TELL THEM THAT FOR ME

NO, DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL THEM THAT FOR ME

PAULA

IN LOVE, ALL'S FAIR

COMME A LA GUERRE

C'EST C'QUE J'AI TOUJOURS DIT

DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL HIM THAT FOR ME
DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL HIM THAT FOR ME

HANRATTY
Do you have any idea where your child is?

FRANK SENIOR
He's always in the air. He's a pilot for Pan Am! What a life!

HANRATTY
Your son isn't a pilot with anyone, Mister Abagnale. He never was. Your son is a counterfeiter and a con man.

FRANK SENIOR
I knew that. I just wanted to see what you knew. *(looks HANRATTY over)* You expect a father to give up his son.

HANRATTY
Yes, I do. I expect a father to do that. Now listen to me, Mister Abagnale. People get shot in my line of work. Real guns. Real bullets. I'd like to bring him in alive.

FRANK SENIOR
Okay. Here's the truth. *(waves an envelope)* Got a letter from him just today. He signed up. He's over in Nam, serving his country.

HANRATTY
Can I see that letter?

FRANK SENIOR *(shakes his head, puts letter away)*
No return address. He's in country, risking his life for you and me. Not a bad way to leave his troubles behind, I'd say. He got out of the game at just the right time.

HANRATTY
The game?

FRANK SENIOR
You know, the game. Don't let the man get the best of you. Look out for yourself, when the banks and the government and the big boys try to rob you blind.

HANRATTY
Is that what you taught your son?

FRANK SENIOR
A man should go after what he wants in life.

HANRATTY
A man should face up to what he's done.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
These two need some music. *(MUSIC.)* A saloon song for two lonely souls. What could they possibly have in common? Oh yeah. Me.

HANRATTY
Mister Abagnale.

FRANK SENIOR
Please—Frank.

HANRATTY
Frank. Your kid needs you now.

FRANK SENIOR
What can I possibly do for him that he can't do better for himself?

HANRATTY
You can tell him to come in. You can tell him to stop. You might be the only one who can.

FRANK SENIOR
Then I think we're all in a lot of trouble, Carl. Hell, the kid used to see me as Dean Martin, Jesus Christ, and JFK all rolled into one. I couldn't live up to that. I did the best I could. I told him I loved him—every day.

HANRATTY
Maybe you should've told him not to commit grand larceny.

FRANK SENIOR
Way of the world, Carl. Our fathers screw us up; we turn around and do the same to our kids. It's the eternal cycle.

HANRATTY
Until someone breaks it.

<u>LITTLE BOY, BE A MAN</u>
FRANK SENIOR
LITTLE BOY, BE A MAN
YEAH, THAT WAS POP'S ONLY PLAN
HE NEVER KISSED ME OR SANG "BABY MINE"
SURE, I'D HAVE LOVED A HUG BUT HEY, I CAME OUT JUST FINE

AND IF I EVER WOULD CRY
HE'D SMACK THE TEAR FROM OUT MY EYE
HE TOLD ME "GROW UP, KID,

YOU'RE NO PETER PAN. LITTLE BOY, BE A MAN."

HANRATTY
But you want to do your kid better, right?

FRANK SENIOR
You got any kids, Carl?

HANRATTY
I do not.

FRANK SENIOR
Then what the hell do you know about it? I suppose your father was a prince.

HANRATTY
Yeah. Of darkness.

FRANK SENIOR
Hah!

HANRATTY
LITTLE MAN, GROW SOME GAUL

FRANK SENIOR
Oh, he did not.

HANRATTY
I swear to God. Every single day.

THAT MOTTO RANG THROUGHOUT THE HALLS
ON MY TENTH BIRTHDAY HE SHOWED ME A GUN
THEN TOOK ME TO THE CORNFIELDS AND SAID "OKAY ... RUN!"
HIS SENSE OF HUMOR WAS LAME

FRANK SENIOR
Like father, like son.

HANRATTY
LUCKY FOR ME, SO WAS HIS AIM!
IF HE HAD SEWN SOME NEEDLEPOINT
THAT HUNG ON THE WALLS
(IT WOULDA SAID) LITTLE MAN, GROW SOME GAUL

BOTH
BALLGAMES THAT HE MISSED
NIGHTS HE CAME HOME PISSED
WELL, I DON'T THINK ABOUT THAT ANY LONGER

HANRATTY
NO ONE IN THE BLEACHERS

FRANK SENIOR
FISTFIGHTS WITH MY TEACHERS

BOTH
I'M LIVING PROOF WHAT DOESN'T KILL YA
MAKES YA STRONGER!

HANRATTY
So what do you say we set the kid straight, huh Frank?

FRANK SENIOR *(thickly)*
Aw, the kid's great. A pilot! Serving his country! He's doin' fine. *(pulls the envelope out, waves it) (slaps the envelope on the bar)*

HANRATTY
You're sure about that?

FRANK SENIOR
Ya gotta let go, Carl. Can't hold on forever.
LITTLE MAN, LITTLE ME
THEY COME WITH NO WARRANTY
I TRIED TO FIX IT BUT WHO WOULD HAVE GUESSED

BOTH
IT'S HARD TO SAY BUT FATHER DOESN'T ALWAYS KNOW BEST

FRANK SENIOR
SO CARL, WHEN YOU HAVE A KID

HANRATTY
MY EX SAID HEAVEN FORBID

FRANK SENIOR
DO AS I SAY, NOT AS I DID

BOTH
LIKE DAD AFTER DAD AFTER DAD AFTER DAD
SINCE THE WHOLE MESS BEGAN

FRANK SENIOR
YOU DO THE BEST YOU CAN

HANRATTY
LITTLE BOY, BE A MAN

(HANRATTY watches FRANK SENIOR waver, sit hard, and pass out cold, head on the bar. Music switches to "MAN INSIDE THE CLUES" HANRATTY picks up the letter. Checks the return address. Slaps it against his hand.)

BARTENDER
Anything else for ya?

HANRATTY
Payphone? I need to get to Atlanta. Make sure he gets home, okay? *(pulls out a few bills)*

BARTENDER
Buddy, he is home.

(MUSIC. HANRATTY steps outside the bar.)

MAN INSIDE THE CLUES (REPRISE)

HANRATTY
I'VE LOOKED INTO SO MANY LIVES BUT NEVER GOT THIS CLOSE
THE DISTANCE MADE IT EASIER TO SEE
I LIKE TO DO THE JOB AT HAND
AND THEN IT'S "ADIOS"
BUT HERE'S A CASE THAT'S GOT THE BEST OF ME

AN ENVELOPE WITH HIS ADDRESS
A BRAND NEW SET OF TRACKS
LEADING TO A KID WITH NO ROADS LEFT TO CHOOSE

THERE'S NO ONE LEFT TO SAVE THE DAY
IT'S TIME TO FACE THE FACTS
SO I'LL TAKE THAT RIDE TO THE BOY INSIDE THE CLUES

Scene 4: Atlanta General Hospital

INTERCOM
Code Blue. Code Blue! Party in the I.C.U.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Brenda. *(She groans.)* Brenda come on. It's okay.

BRENDA
I'm sorry, Frank. I want to. I just—I'm not ready.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Brenda, it's okay—I can wait. I'd wait forever for you. I mean, it took a month just to get you to talk to me.

BRENDA
I didn't mean to be rude.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
No, it's fine—I love a challenge.

BRENDA
But why me, Frank? You could have any nurse here. You know girls from everywhere. You've been to Paris, and Italy, and think of all the beautiful women there must be in Germany. Why me?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Because ... I love that you're good at your job and that you work hard. I love that I can be myself around you. I love that I can ask you anything, like ... why'd you leave New Orleans?

BRENDA
(turns away) Oh. No reason. Well—I sort of ran away.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
You ran away! Wow. Why would you do something like that?

BRENDA
I was engaged. To be married. He was the son of my father's law partner, and he wasn't very nice to me, and on the morning of my wedding day I looked at myself in my dress and I realized I didn't want to marry him. And so I left. Home. And I haven't been back since.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Brenda. I'm sorry. You know I'll never hurt you.

BRENDA
You say that now. But we have nothing in common.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I think we have more than you know.

BRENDA
But you're the Harvard graduate world traveler and I'm just ... ordinary.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Ordinary is beautiful. I don't need Paris. I don't need a fancy restaurant or a huge orchestra—just some subtle orchestrations.

[SFX: 16)Seven Wonders]

And maybe a little mood lighting. All that other stuff was just what I found along way ...while I was looking for you.

SEVEN WONDERS
OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'VE SEEN THE SEVEN WONDERS
IF YOU GIVE OR TAKE A FEW
BUT ALL THEM SEVEN WONDERS
WELL, THEY CAN'T COMPARE TO YOU
I'VE BEEN A LOTTA PLACES
YES, I'VE TRAVELED NEAR AND FAR
BUT NOW I KNOW THAT HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE

NIAGARA FALLS? A LEAKY FAUCET THAT A PLUMBER OUGHTA FIX
THE PYRAMIDS? ARE REALLY JUST A DUSTY PILE OF BRICKS.

THE TAJ MAHAL? A FIXER-UPPER.
THE GRAND CANYON? JUST A HOLE.
THE GRAND CANAL IN VENICE? AN EYE-TALIAN TOILET BOWL.

I'VE SEEN THE SEVEN WONDERS IF YOU GIVE OR TAKE A FEW
BUT ALL THEM SEVEN WONDERS
WELL, THEY CAN'T COMPARE TO YOU
I'VE BEEN A LOTTA PLACES
YES, I'VE TRAVELED NEAR AND FAR
BUT NOW I KNOW THAT HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE.

BRENDA
THE AURORA BOREALIS?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR

JUST A NIGHT LIGHT ON THE FRITZ

BRENDA
STONEHENGE?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
JUST A BUNCH OF ROCKS

BRENDA
LA BREA'S TAR?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
THE PITS.

BRENDA
HOW 'BOUT THE LEANING TOWER OF PISA?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
LOOKS LIKE SOMETHING UP AND BROKE.

BRENDA
MOUNT RUSHMORE?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
SOMEONE CLIMB UP THERE AND TELL THEM BOYS A JOKE!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR + BRENDA
YES, MY TRAVELIN' DAYS ARE OVER
GET THE CHECK, I'LL PAY THE BILL
'CAUSE I SEE ALL THE WONDERS
IN YOUR EYES, JUST STANDING STILL.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Do you think you could go home again ... if you were engaged?

BRENDA
Come on, Frank. Don't tease me.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
We could go to your parents, tell them we're in love.

BRENDA
My father is very intimidating. You'll change your mind.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I won't. We can run away tonight.

BRENDA
We can't just run away. You're the overnight ER supervisor.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
The clock's ticking, Brenda. I can't—I don't want to be a doctor forever. I want to make a home with you.

I'VE BEEN A LOTTA PLACES
BUT I'VE LEARNED NOW NEAR AND FAR
THERE'S NO NEED TO ROAM 'CAUSE HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE

BRENDA
THERE'S NO NEED TO ROAM 'CAUSE HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
YES, NOW I KNOW

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR + BRENDA
THAT HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
While Brenda and I catch the train to Nawlins, fast forward a few weeks for a little segment I like to call "Frank's on First."

Scene 5: Hospital Corridor

(MUSIC. Lights on HANRATTY, BRANTON, COD, and DOLLAR with DOCTOR WANAMAKER.)

HANRATTY
Doctor, we're looking for a man who goes by the names of Frank Abagnale, Frank William Abagnale, Frank Taylor, Frank Williams, William Franklin, and William Franklin Williams.

WANAMAKER
That's a lot of names.

HANRATTY
(to quick head shakes from WANAMAKER)
What about Robert Franklin? Frank Thompson? Frank Meyers? Meyer Williams? William Robertson?

WANAMAKER
Robert Wilson?

DOLLAR
Robert Williamson.

HANRATTY
William Robertson.

WANAMAKER
Wilson Robertson?

DOLLAR
Robert Wilkinson?

HANRATTY
Shut up, Dollar.

(Branton pulls out a picture of OLDER FRANK JUNIOR)

BRANTON
Have you seen a man who looked like this?

WANAMAKER
Maybe ... But that man's a pilot.

HANRATTY
He's not a pilot.

WANAMAKER
He looks like a pilot.

HANRATTY
He's not a pilot.

WANAMAKER
So is he a doctor?

HANRATTY
Wait—he's a doctor?

WANAMAKER
Are you asking me or telling me?

HANRATTY
Did he say he's a doctor?

WANAMAKER
Son, do you have any idea who you're looking for?

(Branton pulls out another photo)

BRANTON
Frank William Abagnale Junior.

DOLLAR
A.K.A. Frank Williams, Frank Taylor, Frank—

HANRATTY
Shut up, Dollar.

WANAMAKER
You know, we did have a Frank Conners.

COD
Frank Collins?

WANAMAKER
Frank Conners.

COD
Frank Conners.

HANRATTY
So who's Frank Collins?

WANAMAKER
You tell me, I don't know.

DOLLAR
I knew a Frank Collins in high school.

HANRATTY + COD + BRANTON + WANAMAKER
Shut up, Dollar.

DOLLAR
Jeez.

HANRATTY
Frank Conners. Looked like this?

WANAMAKER
Without the uniform. Ran off with a nurse. Brenda something. Don't know where. Too bad—good doctor. Turned in all his paperwork on time.

HANRATTY
You let this man operate on patients?

WANAMAKER
Oh, no. He just supervised the ER.

HANRATTY
For the love of—Doc, you ever go in to take out someone's appendix and come out with something else?

WANAMAKER
Once or twice. Why?

HANRATTY
Let's go.

(HANRATTY and men leave. MUSIC: Lights change. BRENDA stands nervously in a spot, as if looking into the camera. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR is behind her, supportively.)

Scene 6: The Strong House, New Orleans

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Go ahead. Now.

BRENDA *(to us)*
And now, introducing the newest feature on our show, at home with the Strong family! *(turns to OLDER FRANK JUNIOR)* Are you sure you're ready for this?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I was born ready.

(He gives her a little nudge, and she runs to the dining room. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR continues presenting as each STRONG enters in turn, and stands by the dining room table, in tableau.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(to us)*

Introducing our newest young star, Brenda Strong. And featuring the lovely, witty, refined, and unique Mrs. Carol Strong. And the cultured, brilliant, and incredibly intimidating future father-in-law, Roger Strong ...*(he crosses to join the STRONGS, with some dread)* ... District Attorney.

(The tableau comes to life as all take their seats for dinner. We pick up the scene in progress.)

ROGER
And before Atlanta, you were in California?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Yes, sir. Death Valley Children's Hospital.

ROGER
They have a Children's Hospital in Death Valley?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Yes, sir. Right behind the Macy's.

CAROL
Well goddamn and gumbo, Brenda, I think you landed one this time. Much better than that ratty little Delacroix boy. This one's a hunky hunk of you-betcha.

BRENDA
Mother.

ROGER
Doctor Conners. Do you come from a large family?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Please, sir, call me Frank. I'm an only child, but I hope to have lots of kids. Family is the most important thing.

CAROL
Ding ding! Correct answer. But now for the make-or-break round. Don't lie to me, now. Are you a Lutheran?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Why, yes, I am a Lutheran.

ROGER
Well then, Frank, would you like to say grace?*(off OLDER FRANK JUNIOR's hesitation:)* Unless you're not comfortable.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Oh, no, absolutely. *(folds hands, bows head, thinks)* Two little mice fell into a bucket of cream. The first mouse quickly gave up and drowned but the second mouse, he struggled so hard that he eventually churned that cream into butter and walked out. Amen.

ROGER + BRENDA
Amen…

CAROL
Amen and goddamn that was beautiful. Where did you learn that, you pious piece of cutie-pie?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
The, ah, First Lutheran Church of Death Valley.

ROGER
Frank, have you decided which hospital you want to work at here in New Orleans?

FRANK JUNOR
Well, to be quite honest, I've been thinking about getting back into law.

ROGER
Are you a doctor or a lawyer?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Before I went to medical school, I passed the bar in California. I practiced law for a year, then I decided, why not try my hand at pediatrics?

BRENDA
Well, aren't you full of surprises.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(a look to us: he's surprised himself)*
Yes I am.

CAROL
Sakes alive, the yummy Yankee is a doctor and a lawyer! Oh, Brenda, darlin', you got yourself magic on a stick with this one!

ROGER
Where did you go to law school? Harvard, Yale, Columbia ... ?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Berkeley.

BRENDA + CAROL
Berkeley!

BRENDA
That's where daddy went!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Oh! Wow. Fantastic.

CAROL
Oh my saints and stars, Roger, Frank should work for you. You're always bellyachin' about how hard it is to find assistant prosecutors who aren't bayou inbreds.

BRENDA
Oh, could he Daddy? Could he please? Could he come work with you please?

ROGER
So. Frank. Was that snake Hollingsworth still teaching there when you went through Berkeley?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Hollingsworth ... yes. Grumpy old Hollingsworth, right? I tell ya, meaner than ever.

ROGER
And that dog of his? Tell me Frank, what was the name of his little dog?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
(works the problem, then:) I'm sorry. The dog was dead when I got there.

ROGER
How unfortunate. A doctor, a lawyer, a Lutheran. So what are you, Frank? 'Cause I think you're about to ask my daughter's hand in marriage, and I have a right to know.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Know what, sir?

ROGER
The truth. Tell me the truth, Frank. What are you doing here? What is a man of your accomplishments doing with Brenda? After all, we've been through all this before with her.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Brenda's the best girl I've ever known, sir. She's the real thing.

ROGER
But who are you Frank? If you want my blessing ... If you want my daughter ... I'd like to hear the truth from you now.

CAROL
Oh, Daddy! But, Daddy, look at the time!

ROGER
Is it seven-thirty already?

BRENDA
Is it time for Mitch?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Mitch?

CAROL
Come on, y'all!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Who's Mitch?

ROGER
We'll come back to this, Frank.

(They all head for the couch. MUSIC. MITCH MILLER appears as though on TV.)

MITCH MILLER
NBC Presents: Sing Along With Mitch! Starring me, Mitch Miller, and the Sing Along Gang! Hey! Don't just sit there. Come on and sing!

CAROL
Oh that Mitch Miller, he's so handsome!

(OUR) FAMILY TREE

CAROL + MITCH

I FEEL A MIGHTY QUAKE
THE SOUTH BEGINS TO SHAKE
UNDER OUR FAMILY TREE

THE LEAVES BEGIN TO BLOW
GONE WITH THE WIND THEY GO
ALL THROUGH OUR FAMILY TREE

UP TOP MAGNOLIAS BLOOM
THEY SPREAD A SWEET PERFUME
FOR THIS ANCESTRAL JUBILEE

NOW EVERY BOUGH MUST PULL ITS WEIGHT
IT'S TIME TO PRUNE AND PROPAGATE
WELCOME TO OUR FAMILY TREE

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Wow am I tired – it's been quite a day.

MITCH MILLER
Let's hear from those fantastic fathers!

ROGER + MITCH	CAROL
I HEAR THE DOGWOOD'S BARK	Ruff!
A SEED'S BEGUN TO SPARK	Tsst!
INSIDE OUR FAMILY TREE	FAMILY TREE
A TWIG BEGINS TO POKE	MMMM
FROM OUT THAT MIGHTY OAK	MMMM
TO JOIN OUR JAMBOREE	JAMBOREE
AND LIKE A SLIDE TROMBONE	UH HUH
HE GLIDES OUT FULLY GROWN	WA-WA-WA-WAH
A DIXIELAND R.S.V.P	WOP DOO WOP DOO WOP DO WOW

ROGER

AND NO ONE MINDS AN EXTRA LIMB

CAROL

ESPECIALLY WHEN IT LOOKS LIKE HIM

ROGER + CAROL + MITCH

SO WELCOME TO OUR FAMILY TREE

ROGER
All right Brenda, Your turn.

BRENDA
No! Daddy! You know I can't do it alone.

ROGER *(sighing)*
Brenda.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Aw, she just needs a little help…

MITCH MILLER
Ladies and gentlemen, the Strong Family Singers!

BRENDA + ALL
I FEEL A BURST OF SPRING
MY TRUNK BEGINS TO SWING
JUST LIKE OUR FAMILY TREE
THE COUSINS COME TO CALL
THEY'LL STAY UNTIL NEXT FALL
THERE'S LOTS OF FIXINS AND THEY'RE FREE

MITCH MILLER
SAVE SOME OF THAT GUMBO FOR ME

THE STRONGS
THE KIN FOLK GATHER ROUND

ALL
UH HUH

THE STRONGS
THEY'VE COVERED LOTS OF GROUND

ALL
WA WA WA WAH

THE STRONGS
THERE'S NOT A SOUL LEFT IN TENNESSEE

THE STRONGS	ALL
THEY'VE ALL ARRIVED TO GERMINATE	OOOOHHH
TO FERTILIZE	
AND CULTIVATE	AND CULTIVATE
AND POPULATE OUR FAMILY TREE	AND POPULATE OUR FAMILY TREE

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(stopping the action with a record scratch!)*
Okey. Look. Mr. Strong…It's time I told the truth. The truth, sir ... is ... The truth is I'm not a doctor. I'm not a lawyer. I'm not an airline pilot. I'm nothing, really. I'm just a kid who's in love with your daughter.

(all gasp!)

ROGER *(pause)*
No. I know what you are. You're……a romantic.

(all aww.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR

I am?

ROGER
Yes you are. *(all phew!)* Men like us are nothing without the women we love. So go ahead. Ask me the question you wanted to ask me.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Yes sir. How soon can I take the bar in New Orleans?

(all laugh)

CAROL
Not that question Yankee boy! The other question!

(All laugh.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Well goddamn and gumbo!

BRENDA
Oh, Frank!

I've made a lot of mistakes in my life, but I wouldn't change a single one, because they all led me to you. Brenda Strong, will you marry me?

BRENDA
Yes Frank Conners, I will marry you.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'LL GIVE A REBEL YELL
TO EVERY SOUTHERN BELLE
UNDER OUR FAMILY TREE

I'LL SWING THE SECOND LINE
WHEN OUR TWO CLANS COMBINE
FOR SOME BIG

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR + ROGER
EASY HARMONY

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
WE'LL GO TO VIEUX CARRE
AND DINE ON ENTOUFFE
YOU'VE CHARMED THIS YANKEE REFUGEE

ROGER + CAROL
BOP DOO WOP BA DOO WAH DOO

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
YOU'RE ALL SO LUSH AND OVERGROWN
BUT I KNOW I'LL NEVER BE ALONE
I'M GLAD TO CLIMB YOUR FAMILY TREE

ALL

BOP BOP BOP BOP BOP

ROGER + CAROL + BRENDA + FRANK	ALL
	WOW
YOUR LOVE HAS RAISED THE BAR	
	DOO WOW!
I'M SWINGIN' ON A STAR	
	DOO WOP!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
FOR THAT WHO NEEDS A LAW DEGREE?!?

ALL
THE TREES THAT BEAR THE RIPEST FRUITS
ARE THE TREES THAT HAVE THE DEEPEST ROOTS

ALL EXCEPT OLDER FRANKJUNIOR
SO WELCOME TO OUR FAMILY

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'M WELCOME IN THE FAMILY TREE!

ALL
WELCOME TO OUR FAMILY TREE

MITCH MILLER
Look out old Frankie is home!

Scene 7: Dive Bar, New Rochelle

(FRANK SENIOR, in a postal uniform, at the bar, a crusty old BARTENDER behind it. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR enters.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Dad.

FRANK SENIOR
*(turns, doesn't go to him)*What are you doing here?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I came to see you. Why are you dressed like that?

FRANK SENIOR
I took a job. A government job. I'm beating them at their own game. I'm a government employee—you see how beautiful that is? You got a good lawyer?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I sort of am a lawyer now…

FRANK SENIOR
Look at this letter. The I.R.S. wants more. They ate the cake. Now they want the crumbs. You know what? I'll make them chase me. For the rest of their lives.*(looks at OLDER FRANK JUNIOR)* I had an FBI agent come see me.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR

Mister Hanratty.

FRANK SENIOR
You got their number, son. The United States government, champ. Running for the hills.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Dad. It's over. I'm gonna stop now.

FRANK SENIOR
They're never gonna catch you, Frankie. Why would you stop?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'm settling down. I'm going to raise a family. *(reaches into his coat, pulls out an invitation)* I came here to give you this. It's an invitation to an engagement party. Daddy, I'm getting married. Can you believe it? I'm getting married. I've got two tickets for you and mom, first-class, for the wedding—

FRANK SENIOR
Why would you do that? You're on top of the world.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'm changing my life, Dad. And you won't have to worry about anything anymore. The house, the Cadillac, Everything they took from us. I'm going to get it all back. And Mom's gonna see—

FRANK SENIOR
Your mother's remarried. To my friend Jack Barnes. They have a house out on Long Island.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Why would she do that?

FRANK SENIOR
Don't get married, Frankie.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
But—why would she do that to us?

FRANK SENIOR
There's no us anymore. Listen to me. I'm your father.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Then tell me to stop.

FRANK SENIOR
Why would I tell you to stop?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Because you're my father.

FRANK SENIOR
You can't stop. You're on a winning streak. You gotta ride it. You gotta ride that, baby.
(as OLDER FRANK JUNIOR begins to back away.) You're an Abagnale! *(a cappella, he sings:)*

THEY KNEW THE KEY TO LIFE

(OLDER FRANK JR. pushes him away and exits.)

Hey, come on and sing it with me, Frankie

...CAUSE WHEN LEMONS CLOG YOUR SINK UP
DON'T JUST STAND AROUND AND SCREAM

(to the band) Hey, hit it guys ...Frankie. *(No music starts.)*

SPIKE SOME LEMONADE AND DRINK UP
AND MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM
JUST MAKE BUTTER ...

(speaks, almost inaudibly, and almost in darkness:)

(Suddenly a jangly phone RING pierces the darkness. OLDER FRANK JUNIOR steps into one spot, HANRATTY into another. Both on the phone.)

HANRATTY
Well, well, Doctor Conners. What do you want?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I want it to be over. I'm getting married, Carl. I'm settling down. I'm going to have a family.

HANRATTY
You have stolen almost two million dollars. You think we're just going to call that a wedding present? This is not something that you can run away from, Frank. You will be caught. You will go to jail. Where did you think this was headed?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Please let me stop, Carl. Please.

HANRATTY
You're scared because you know I'm getting closer. I know you rented that car in Shreveport. The hotel in Lake Charles. You're scared. And you're tired.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'm getting married, Carl. I met the girl ... the one.

HANRATTY
And does she know the truth? About who you are?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Do you?

HANRATTY
Almost all of it.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Goodbye Carl.

(OLDER FRANK JUNIOR hangs up. HANRATTY hangs up, but OLDER FRANK JUNIOR stands stock still in his spot. Branton joins HANRATTY).

HANRATTY
Listen, get all the Louisiana papers, last two months. Look for an engagement notice. Frank Conners.

BRANTON
He would've changed his name by now.

HANRATTY
He can't. She knows him as Frank Conners. He loses the name, he loses the girl.

(Branton snaps his fingers, and goes. HANRATTY looks at us.)

HANRATTY
They always make a mistake.

Blackout.

Scene 8: Brenda's Bedroom, Strong House, New Orleans

(OLDER FRANK JUNIOR madly pulling suitcases from beneath the bed. BRENDA sweeps in, in a party dress.)

BRENDA
Frank, where should I put these? They're checks, engagement gifts from Daddy's friends—*(breaks off, sees what he's doing)* What're you doing? Everyone's downstairs waiting to meet the groom-to-be.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
We have to leave, Brenda.

BRENDA
What?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
You love me, right?

BRENDA
Of course, Frank. What’s going on?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I mean, you love me no matter what?

BRENDA
Well—of course.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Whether I was poor, or whether I was sick, or whether I had a different name?

(He opens a suitcase to throw some clothes in, and it's full of money.)

BRENDA
Frank, where'd you get all that money?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
A name, right—what's a name? My name is Frank Conners, right? That's who I am with you. But we all have secrets. Sometimes when I travel, I use the name Frank Taylor. That's my secret.

BRENDA

Frank, what are you talking about? Why are you saying all this?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I don't want to lie to you anymore. I'm not a doctor. I never went to medical school. I'm not a lawyer, or a Harvard graduate, or a Berkeley graduate, or a ... a Lutheran. I ran away from home two years ago when I was sixteen.

BRENDA
Frank ... You're not a Lutheran?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Okay. Here's what we're gonna do. In two days, you're gonna meet me at Miami International Airport. Here's money. You're gonna leave the house after your parents go to sleep, take a taxi cab, give the driver that money and tell him to drive all through the night. And you're not going to tell anyone. Not even your parents.

BRENDA
Frank, I can't. I'll be too afraid—I'm no good at lying.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
You know you can do this. It's like I told you before—act like you're brave, and you will be.*(He grabs the suitcase to go.)*

BRENDA
Frank! Please. Before you go. Please tell me your name.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
My name. Is Frank. William. Abagnale. Junior.

BRENDA
I love you, Frank.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I love you too. I have to go now.

BRENDA
Frank—

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Shh. No time for goodbyes. I'm gonna see you real soon.

BRENDA
I don't think I can do this alone

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I know you can. You have to. The spotlight's on you now.

(He slips out)

CAROL *(offstage)*
Brenda!

(HANRATTY, COD, CAROL and ROGER enter the room)

HANRATTY
Brenda. Where is he?
.
BRENDA
He's gone

HANRATTY
Where'd he go? *(gets no answer, then, gently:)* Listen to me, Brenda, sweetheart, this could end very badly. We've got men after him in every state. Men who shoot to kill. You need to tell me where he's going. Now!

BRENDA
I can't. *(Cod bursts in.)*

COD
Hanratty. Three of the guests saw someone leaving out the back.

HANRATTY
(to BRENDA, moving to go) Don't go anywhere.

(HANRATTY, CAROL, and COD go.)

ROGER
Brenda, darling, if you love him, you'll do the right thing. *(BRENDA continues to stare.)* Young lady. *(ROGER shakes his head and exits.)*

FLY, FLY AWAY

BRENDA

WHEN I WAS A CHILD
MY EYES WERE CLEAR,
I SAW THE GOOD SIDE
THAT'S THE KIND OF SECOND SIGHT
THAT DOESN'T LAST TOO LONG

BUT WHEN I WAS LOST
I HEARD A VOICE THAT BROUGHT ME HEALING
THAT'S THE KIND OF SPECIAL HOPE
HE BROUGHT ME WITH HIS SONG

PEOPLE ONLY SAW THE DOCTOR, LAWYER,
INDIAN CHIEF
BUT HE WAS JUST
A LONELY LITTLE BOY TO ME.

WITH HIS SWEET AND GENTLE TOUCH,
HE SURE UNLOCKED MY SOUL
SO IN RETURN,
I SURELY WANT TO HELP TO SET HIM FREE ...

YEAH, NOW I WANNA SEE HIM FLY ... FLY ...
I'LL BE YOUR ALIBI MY BABY
FLY, FLY, FLY AWAY ...

I DIDN'T GET TO SAY GOODBYE, GOODBYE
NO NEED TO TELL ME WHY MY BABY
MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY

BRENDA	STEWARDESS/NURSES
	OOH-OOH. MMM-MMM.
	OOH-OOH. AH-AH
MEN WHO THEY CALL REAL	
WERE REALLY FAKES WHO LEFT ME NOTHING	
BUT THIS MAN THEY CALL A FAKE	
GAVE ME SOMETHING REAL	MMM-MMM-MMM
I'VE KNOWN CRUEL, CRUEL MEN	
WITH CHRISTIAN NAMES	AH. AH-AH. MMM-MMM.
WHO TAUGHT ME MANNERS	
BUT THIS MAN WITHOUT A NAME	OOH-OOH
TAUGHT ME HOW TO FEEL	
	OOH-OOH
THEY ONLY SAW THE MAGIC TRICKS	AAH-OOH-OOH.
THE SMOKE AND MIRRORS	
WAS I THE ONLY ONE	OOH-OOH-OOH.
TO EVER SEE THE BOY	OOH-OOH-OOH
SO NOW THEY WANNA CLIP HIS PRECIOUS WINGS	BOY. AAH-AAH.
AND BRING HIM DOWN	
	BRING HIM DOWN
BUT IN HIS HEART AND SOUL'S	AAH-AAH.
THE KIND OF GOOD THEY CAN'T DESTROY	
	OOH-OOH-OOH
YEAH, NOW I WANNA SEE HIM	
FLY ... FLY ...	
I'LL BE YOUR ALIBI MY BABY	FLY
FLY, FLY, FLY AWAY	
	FLY AWAY
WE DIDN'T GET TO SAY GOODBYE, GOODBYE	
NO NEED TO TELL ME WHY MY BABY	GOODBYE
MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE	
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY	MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
BABY WHEN YOU'RE IN THE CLOUDS	OOH-OOH. AAH.
PLEASE KEEP A LOOKOUT	AAH-AAH. OOH-OOH-
MAYBE DARLING FIND A HIDEAWAY	OOH-OOH.
FOR YOU AND I	AAH.
YOU AND I	YOU AND I.
NOW I'LL SEE HIM	OOH …
FLY ... FLY ...	
I'LL BE YOUR ALIBI MY BABY	FLY … FLY …

FLY, FLY, FLY AWAY ...

WE DIDN'T GET TO SAY GOODBYE, GOODBYE
NO NEED TO TELL ME WHY MY BABY
MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY

MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY

MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY

AND I'LL BE WAITING FOR YOU THERE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY.

FLY, FLY, FLY AWAY …

GOODBYE

OOH-OOH. OOH-OOH.
AAH-AAH

AAH-AAH. OOH.

OOH-OOH-OOH-OOH.
OOH-OOH-OOH.

FLY, FLY AWAY.

(Lights to black. In black, the deafening roar of a jet plane taking off.)

Scene 9: Miami International Airport

(Lights on the same airport scene we saw at rise: Dollar has just fired his gun.)

HANRATTY
For the love of — Dollar, what does "hold your fire" mean where you come from?

DOLLAR *(proud)*
I fired a warning shot, Agent Hanratty!

COD *(squints at ceiling)*
I think you shot down a plane.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
That was close! You could hurt someone.

HANRATTY
Come on, Frank. I'd rather take you alive than dead.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Can I at least make a statement first?

HANRATTY
At the airport? No.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'm sure these people want to know why you're shooting at me.

(He looks to them. They kind of do.)

I think they should know who I am and what I did and why I did it.

HANRATTY
This is one of your tricks. Men! *(Jerks his head to the Agents, who close in)* You're not going to fool me again, Frank. Like you did in that hotel room in L.A. You're not putting on a show for these

people.

(He smiles at us, but this time there's no stinger from the orchestra—only silence. He crosses downstage, lost in thought. The Agents watch him closely.)

HANRATTY
Branton, Cod, get everyone out of here.

BRANTON
Hanratty don't let him-

HANRATTY
I got this. Just go.

(The other agents hurry the passengers to the exits.)

HANRATTY
How does it all end, Frank? What happens when it's all over?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
You mean …When the show's over?

HANRATTY
That's right.

<u>GOODBYE</u>

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
IT'S MY HAPPY ENDING.

HANRATTY
It doesn't end because you want it to.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
NOW IT'S TIME TO SAY GOODNIGHT—

HANRATTY
You don't walk out of our life as if it never happened.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
WE CAN STOP PRETENDING.

HANRATTY
You don't get to do that.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
TELL THE SPOTLIGHT MAN TURN OFF MY LIGHT.

HANRATTY
This is not something that you can walk away from.

(But OLDER FRANK JUNIOR pays no heed, coming downstage to speak to us: our host.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR

It’s sure been an exciting run, but it’s time for me to settle down to a quiet family life, with my beloved Brenda.

HANRATTY
You left Brenda behind.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
She'll be here. Any minute.*(HANRATTY murmurs into his walkie-talkie.)*

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
'CAUSE THE SHOW IS DONE NOW
AND IT'S TIME TO LEAVE THE STAGE.
YEAH, THE GOOD GUY WON NOW
AND THE BAND HAS NO MORE SONGS TO PLAY
IT'S A HAPPY ENDING SO I'LL SAY
GOODBYE

GOODBYE TO ALL THE MAKE BELIEVE
GOODBYE
THERE'S NO MORE MAGIC UP MY SLEEVE

THERE'S NOTHING LEFT TO ACT UP HERE
I'LL TAKE MY BOW AND DISAPPEAR
NO QUESTIONS LEFT FOR ANSWERING
THERE'S ONLY ONE WORD LEFT TO SING
GOODBYE

(BRENDA appears.)

BRENDA
Frank!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Brenda! Just in time. *(He starts toward her but stops short when Branton and Dollar appear behind her.)* Brenda?

HANRATTY
Brenda was your mistake. We followed her right to you.

BRENDA
Frank, I’m sorry. I tried.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
It’s okay. I understand.

BRENDA
Frank—I love you.

HANRATTY
All right, get her out of here.

(And they do.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(after she's gone)*

Yeah. I loved you too.

HANRATTY
It’s time to give up, Frank.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
IT'S A HAPPY ENDING
TO THE GREATEST SHOW ON EARTH.
NOW THE CURTAIN'S DESCENDING
AND I HOPE YOU GOT YOUR MONEY'S WORTH

HANRATTY
Let’s go.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
My dad’s waiting for me up north. We're gonna move back to New Rochelle, we’re gonna open up the store—

HANRATTY
Your dad’s dead, Frank. I’m sorry to be the one to tell you. Grand Central Station-he fell down some steps and broke his neck. The police report said he had been drinking.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
You’re lying to me.

HANRATTY
I don't lie.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
No. You don't get to say that. That's not how this ends.

HANRATTY
I’m sorry, Frank.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
GONNA STOP THE SHOW NOW
'CAUSE I WANNA LEAVE ON TOP
SO GET UP AND GO NOW
'CAUSE THERE'S NOTHING LEFT INSIDE MY HEAD
EVERYTHING THAT'S LEFT TO SAY'S BEEN SAID

BUT GOODBYE
GOODBYE TO ALL THE SONG AND DANCE
GOODBYE
OFFSTAGE I STAND A BETTER CHANCE

THE SHOW IS THROUGH, THE PART'S BEEN PLAYED
NO STANDING IN THE WINGS AFRAID
NO VIOLINS OR PHONY TEARS
THE WORD THAT'S MUSIC TO MY EARS IS GOODBYE
GOODBYE GOODBYE GOODBYE

I'M NOT AFRAID OF STOPPING
THIS END COULD BE MY START

I WANNA LIVE A LIFE
AND NOT JUST PLAY A PART
I'LL WALK INTO THE SUNSET
I'LL SAIL ACROSS THE SEA
THE FINAL WORD
THE LAST YOU'LL HEAR OF ME
OF ME
IS GOODBYE

GOODBYE TO EVERY NIGHT ALONE
GOODBYE
GOODBYE TO LIVES THAT I DON'T OWN

I'M TIRED OF LIVING ON THE STAGE
A LIFE THAT'S ONLY ON THE PAGE
THE EMPTY LIVES ARE IN THE PAST
I'VE TRIED BEFORE, BUT HERE'S THE LAST
GOODBYE
GOODBYE GOODBYE GOODBYE!

(OLDER FRANK JUNIOR is alone on stage. Frozen in a spot. Long after the applause has ended. No—he's not alone. HANRATTY.)

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I don't understand. The show's over, Mister Hanratty.

HANRATTY
Yup. Back to real life. Time to face up to what you've done. It's time to stop.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
What if I don't know how?

HANRATTY
You don't have a choice.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I could go. I could run, right now.

HANRATTY
I know, but you won't.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
How do you know?

HANRATTY
Because you're tired of running. Because it won't bring your dad back.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I know. I just wanted to help him get back on his feet.

HANRATTY
I know. Listen, come with me. You do your time, pay your debt to society and we'll get you out early. You'll come work for the Bureau.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
At the FBI?

HANRATTY
We need your know-how. We're years behind in counterfeit and forgery, and now with these computers and credit cards coming in, it's only going to get worse ...

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
But why would you want to help me?

HANRATTY
(Pause.) Because I'm the only one who can. *(Pause.)*

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Thanks, Mister Hanratty. *(OLDER FRANK JR. swiftly embraces HANRATTY.)*

HANRATTY
Hey, Frank. Merry Christmas, son.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
The FBI? Really? You're gonna lock me up, then let me out and pay me for what you locked me up for?

HANRATTY
That's what I said.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Would I get a badge?

HANRATTY
Even better. You'll get a life.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
So how do we end this?

HANRATTY
Your way.

(STUCK TOGETHER) STRANGE BUT TRUE

HANRATTY
STOP YOUR SOBBIN' KID, BEFORE I SHOOT.
YOUR NOSE IS RUNNING ON MY ONLY SUIT.
WHO'D HAVE THOUGHT I'D SHARE THIS DANCE WITH YOU
LOOKS LIKE WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER
WHICH IS STRANGE BUT TRUE.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR *(wipes his eyes, musters a smile)*
GUESS YOU CAUGHT ME, NOW THE CHASE IS DONE.
YOU MUST ADMIT I GAVE YOU QUITE THE RUN.
MISTER TORTOISE—HERE'S YOUR RABBIT STEW.
LOOKS LIKE WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER
WHICH IS STRANGE BUT TRUE.

HANRATTY
TELL MISTER RIPLEY AT "BELIEVE IT OR NOT"

HANRATTY + OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
THE SHOW IS OVER AND HE'S ALL THAT I GOT.

HANRATTY
HARD TO BELIEVE IT BUT WE'RE TYING THE KNOT
TODAY

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
THAT'S OKAY.

HANRATTY
FRANK, THANK YOUR PUBLIC WHILE YOU'RE STILL IN YOUR PRIME.
THEY WON'T BE SEEING YOU FOR QUITE A LONG TIME.
AND AFTER YOU'VE PAID FOR YOUR LIFE OF CRIME
WELL, KID WE'LL SEE WHAT GOOD BEHAVIOR CAN DO.

HANRATTY AND OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
'TIL THEN WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER
WHICH IS STRANGE BUT TRUE.

HANRATTY
Keep your promise. How'd you cheat on the bar exam?

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I didn't cheat. I studied.

HANRATTY
No! I hate you.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Agent Hanratty turned out to be as good as his word.

HANRATTY
Frank was sentenced to fifteen years in prison but was released after seven for good behavior.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
Carl and I became good friends, and he even was the godfather to my kids.

HANRATTY
Brenda married a real doctor and lived happily ever after.

CAROL
Woo! Woo!

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I set up my own security company and would pay back every bad check I passed.

CHERYL ANN
He never paid me back.

HANRATTY

Not now, Cheryl Ann. Let it go.

(MUSIC BUILDS as the full cast enters.)

ALL
HEY, MISTER LAWYER, MISTER TWO-ON-THE-AISLE—
YOU NEVER CAN PREDICT WHEN FORTUNE MAY SMILE.

HANRATTY
IN FACT, I THINK I'M GONNA BREAK WITH TRADITION.
AND TELL J. EDGAR HOOVER, "BABY I'VE GONE FISHIN'!"

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
IF YOU HAD READ THIS, YOU'D HAVE SAID "NO WAY!"

YOUNG FRANK JUNIOR
I ALMOST MAKE IT LOOK LIKE CRIME DOES PAY
THERE'S LOTS OF FOLKS THAT I MISS EVERYDAY

(He looks around at all the faces from his past—the full company.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR + HANRATTY
BUT NOW A NEW DUET HAS MADE ITS DEBUT
AND NOW WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER

ALL
OH YEAH!

BOTH
IN AND OUT OF LUCK TOGETHER!

ALL
OH YEAH!

BOTH
I'M GLAD WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER WHICH IS STRANGE BUT TRUE.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
YOUR JUNIOR PARTNER CAME THROUGH.

HANRATTY
A SIMPLE CASE OF MONKEY SEE, MONKEY DO.

OLDER FRANK JUNIOR
I'M GLAD TO BE ON YOUR TEAM.

HANRATTY
LET'S MAKE SOME BUTTER OUT OF CREAM!

THE END.